

Fall 2022

Research February 2023

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey Background

- Covers all modes – Bus, Rail, Light Rail & Access Link
- Conducted in Spring and Fall
- Methodology has remained consistent to track scores over time
  - Customers rate their satisfaction with service traits on a scale of 0 to 10
  - Customers identify the most important service traits
- Survey is administered online with an extensive campaign to increase participation and boost response rates in target markets

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2022 Survey Background

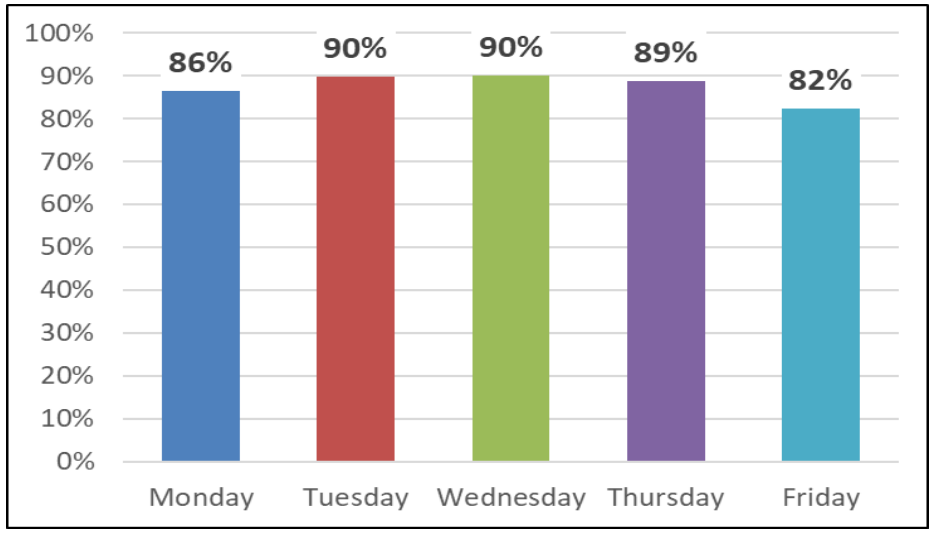
- Conducted from November 14th through December 9th
- Received about 23,000 surveys
- Survey included standard Customer Satisfaction questions and COVID-related questions
- To encourage more participation -- offered 250 NJT Rewards Points to all customers that completed the survey and were a member or signed up for NJT Rewards

TRANSIT

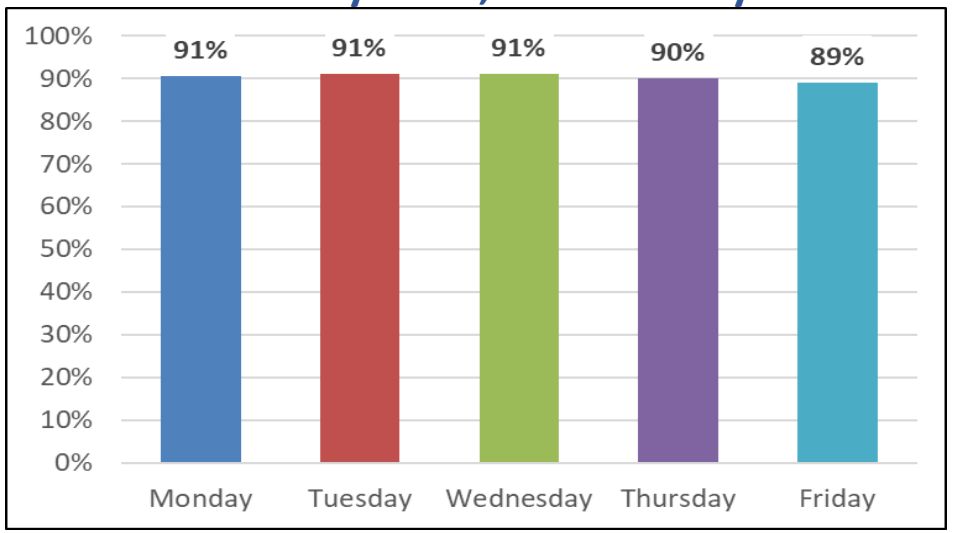
COVID-Related Findings - Travel to the Office/Worksite on NJ TRANSIT by Day of the week

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

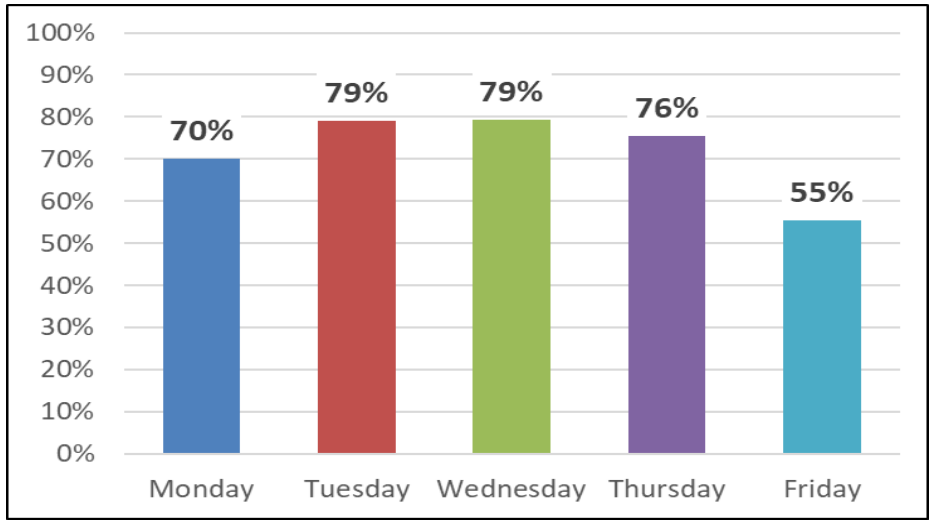
Bus – NY Interstate



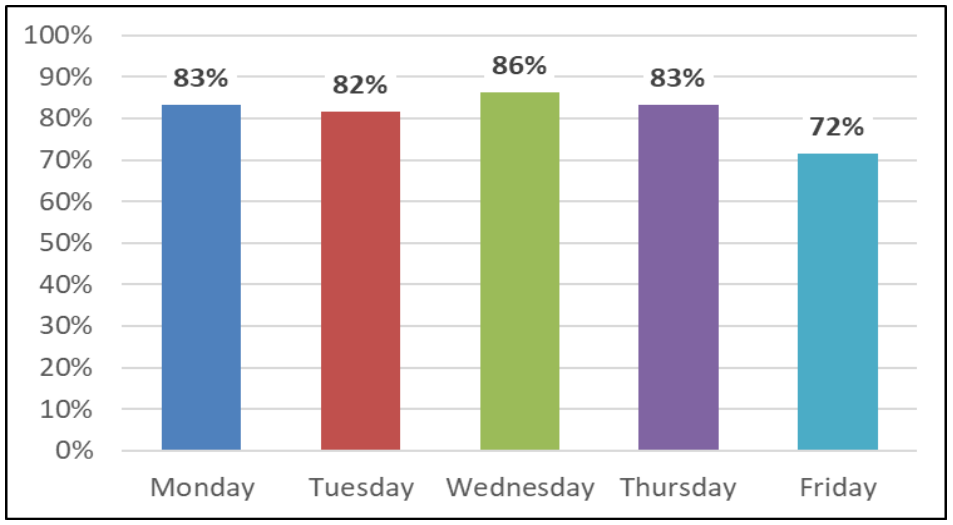
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



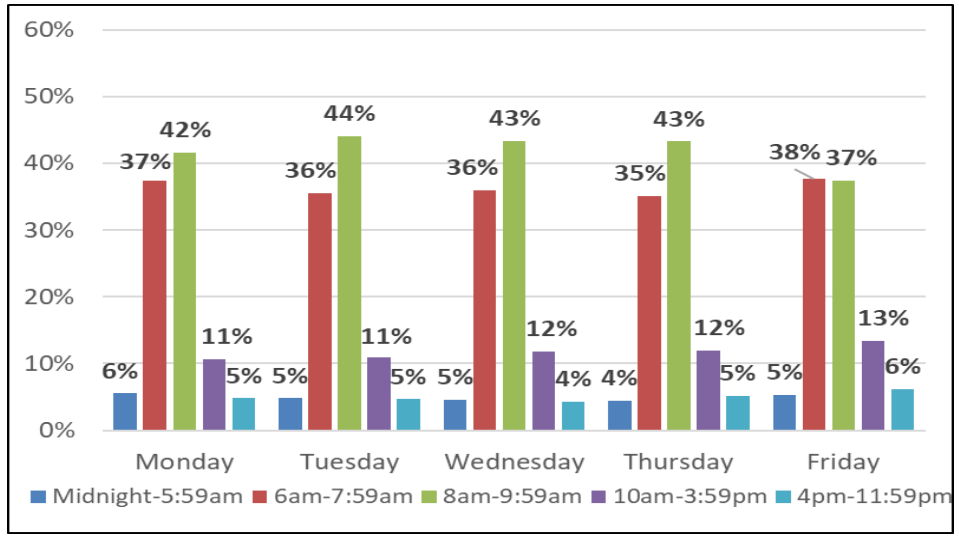
- Most trips to the office or worksite are occurring during the middle of the week
- On Fridays, the fewest customers travel to the office or worksite

NJ TRANSIT

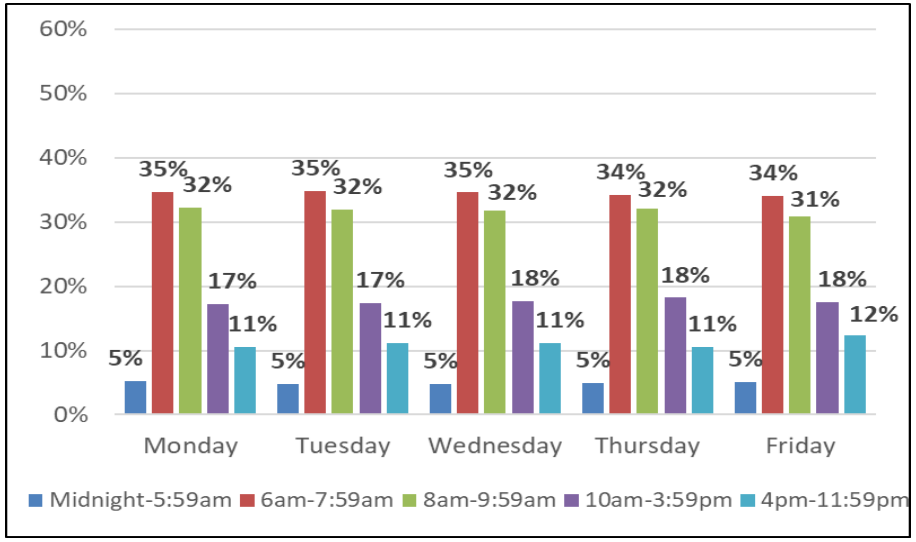
COVID-Related Findings
Work Arrival Time by Day of the Week

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

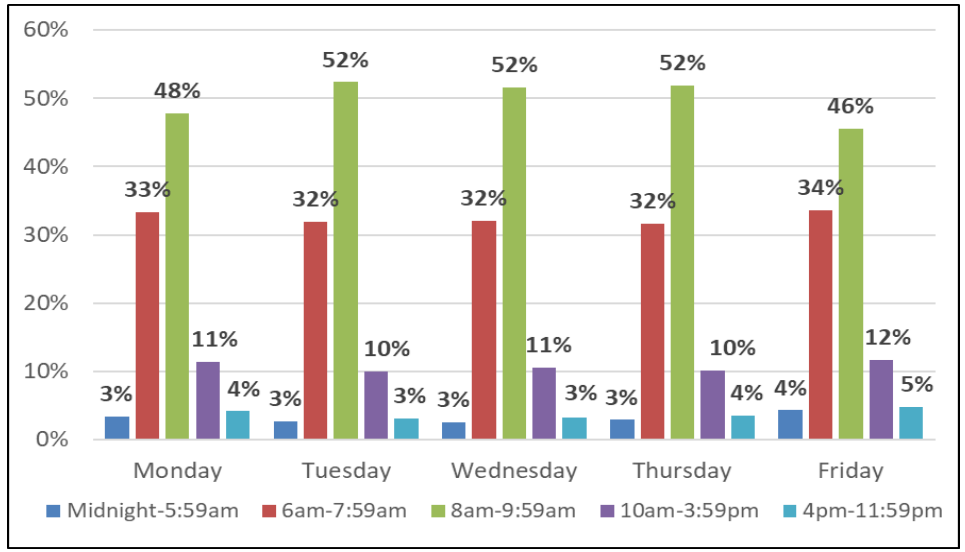
Bus – NY Interstate



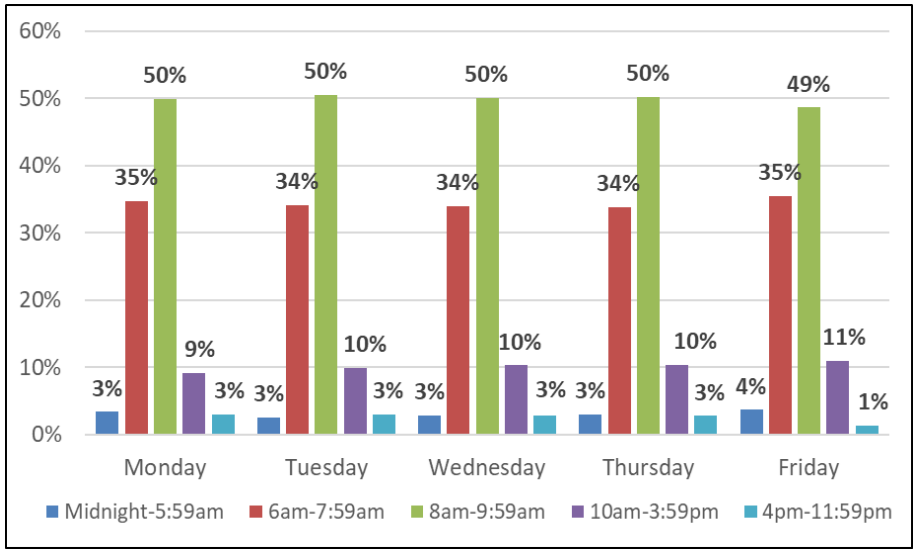
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail

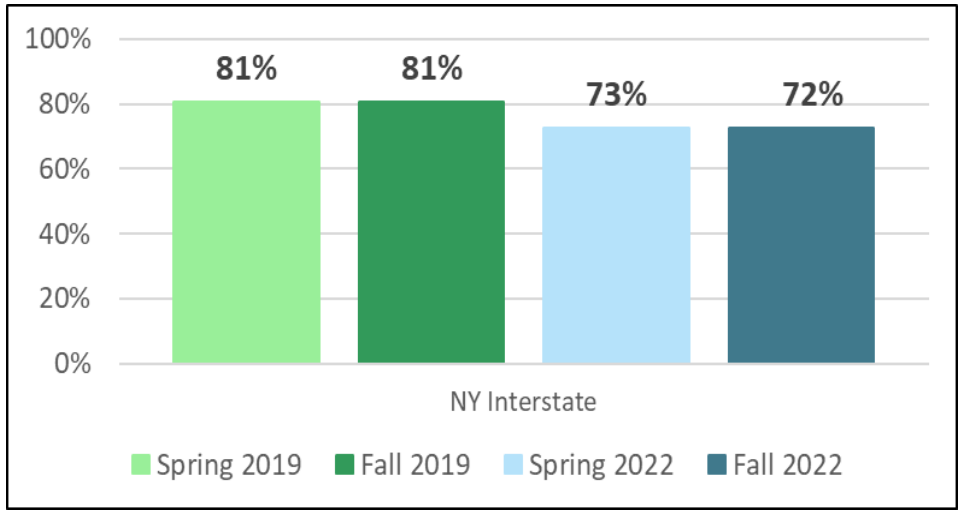


TRANSIT

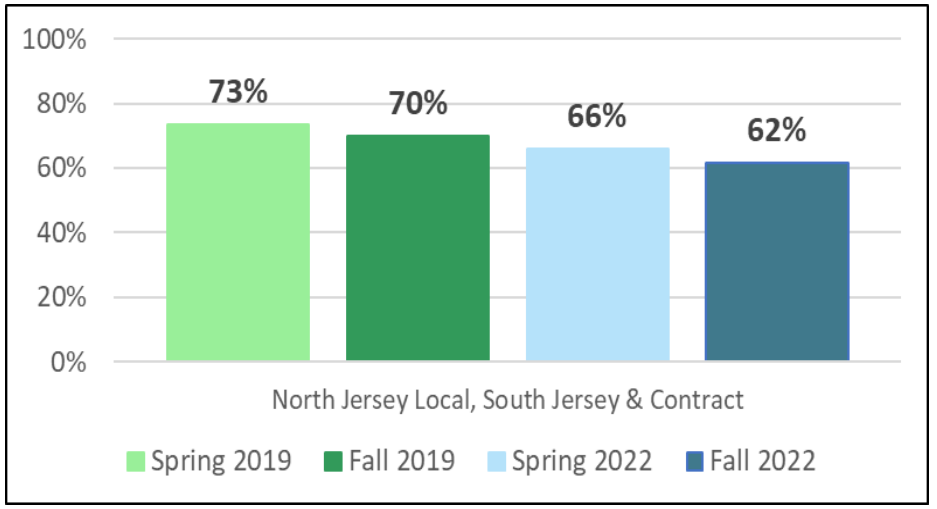
COVID-Related Findings – What is the main purpose of your most frequent trip on NJ TRANSIT? Percent of customers that answered WORK

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

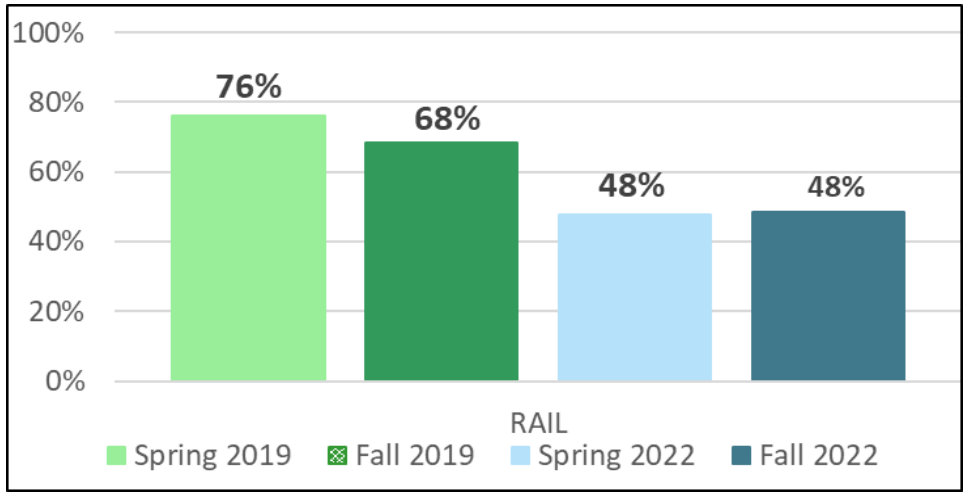
Bus – NY Interstate



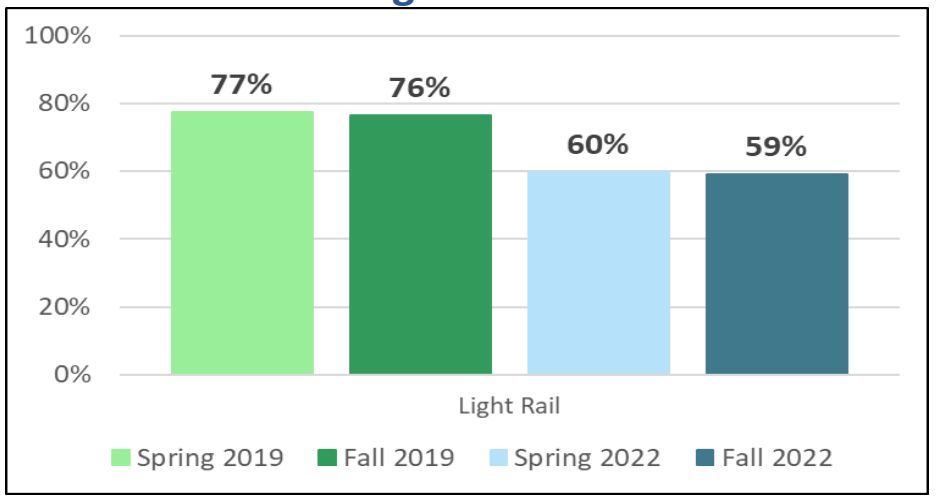
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



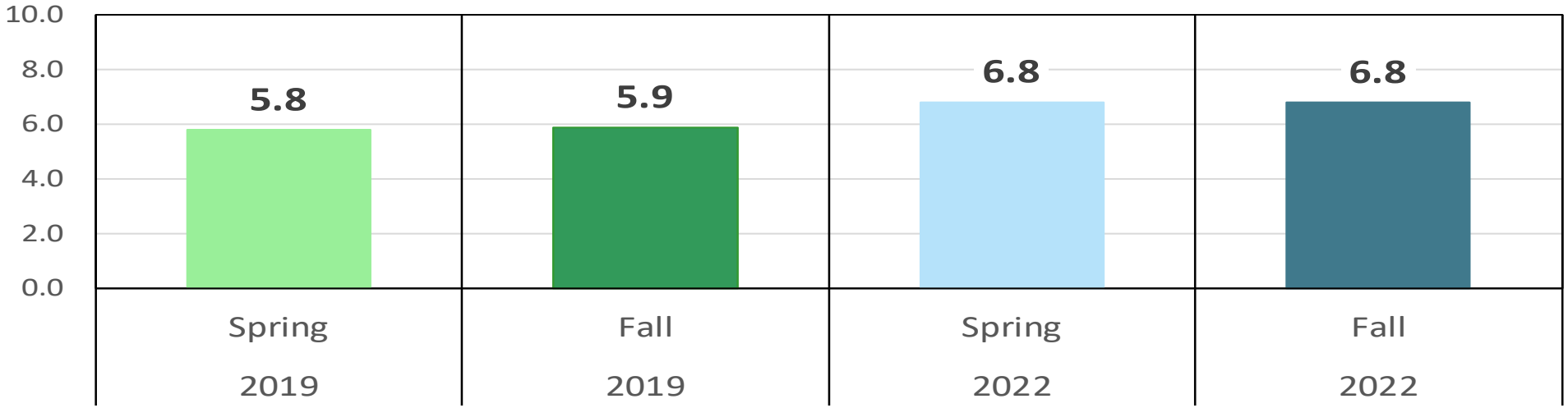
- The percent of survey respondents that said the main purpose of their trip was **Work** has declined since before COVID

TRANSIT

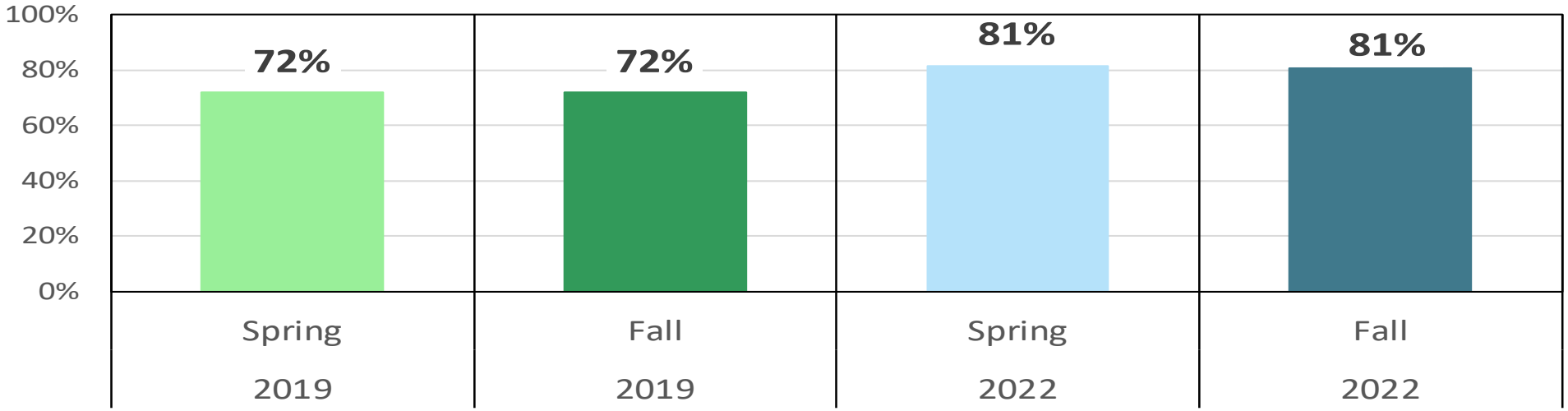
System-Wide Results

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT



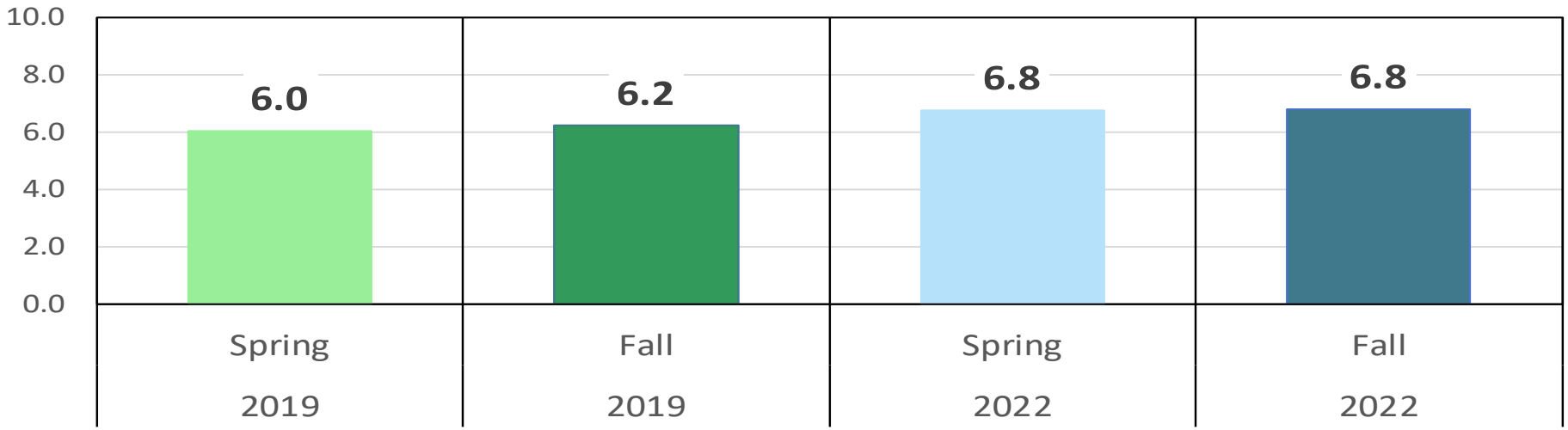
NJ TRANSIT

BUS

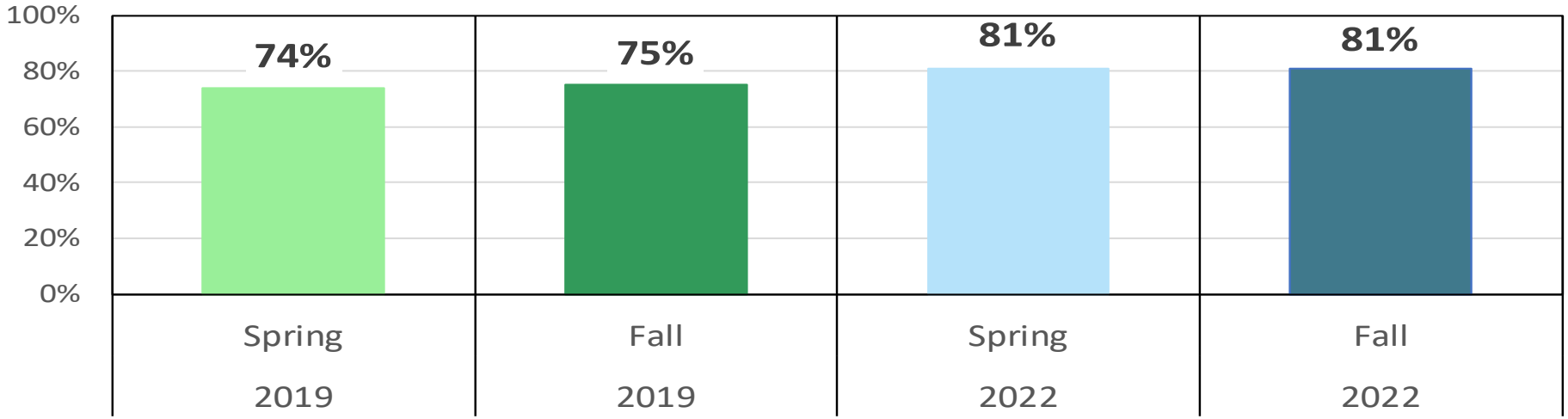
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2022

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



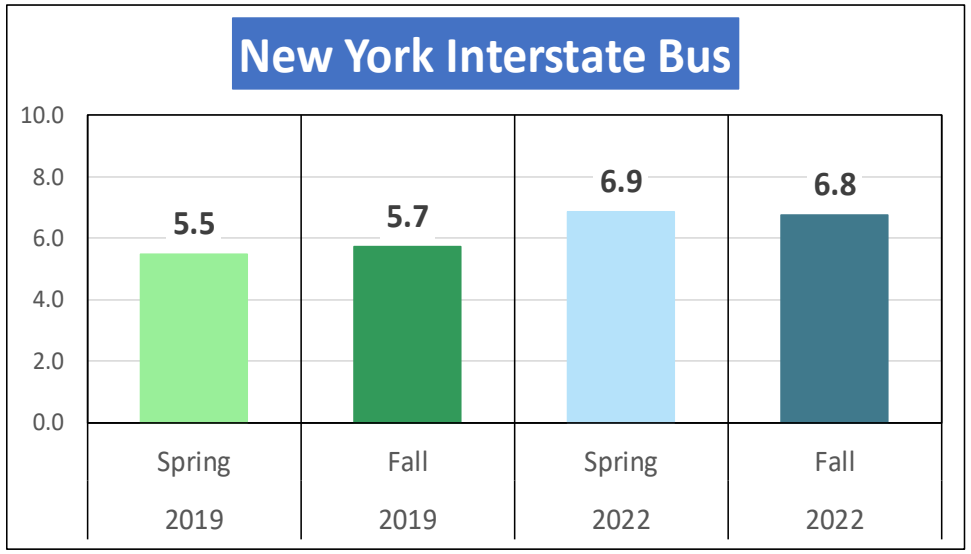
LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT

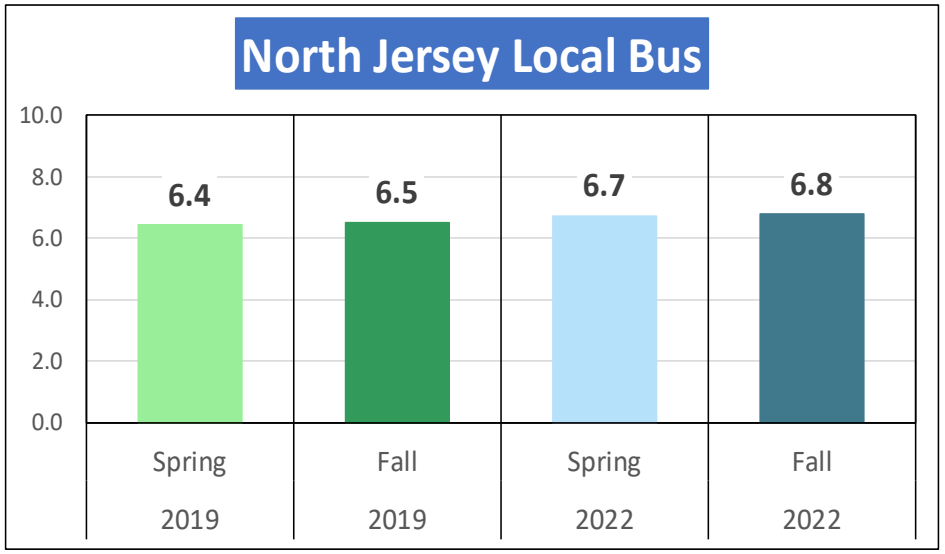


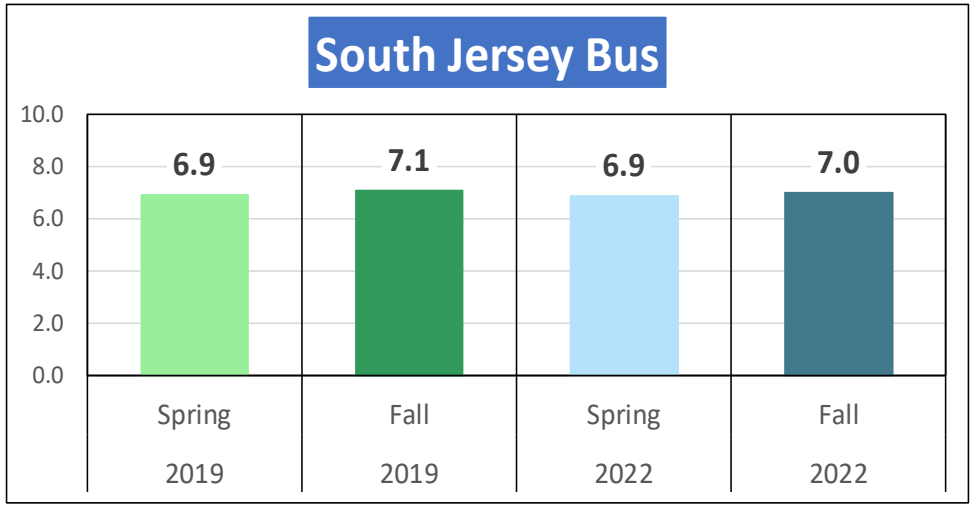
TRANSIT

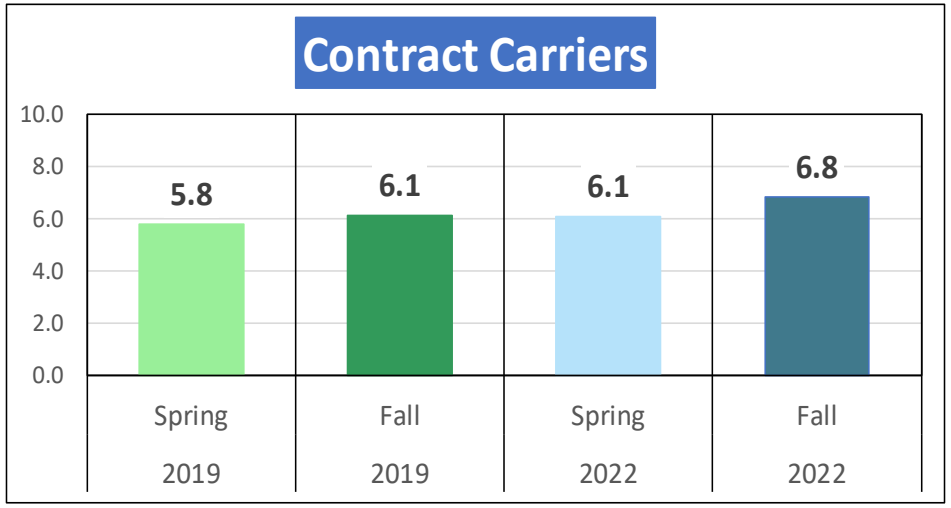
Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT by Bus Market

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022









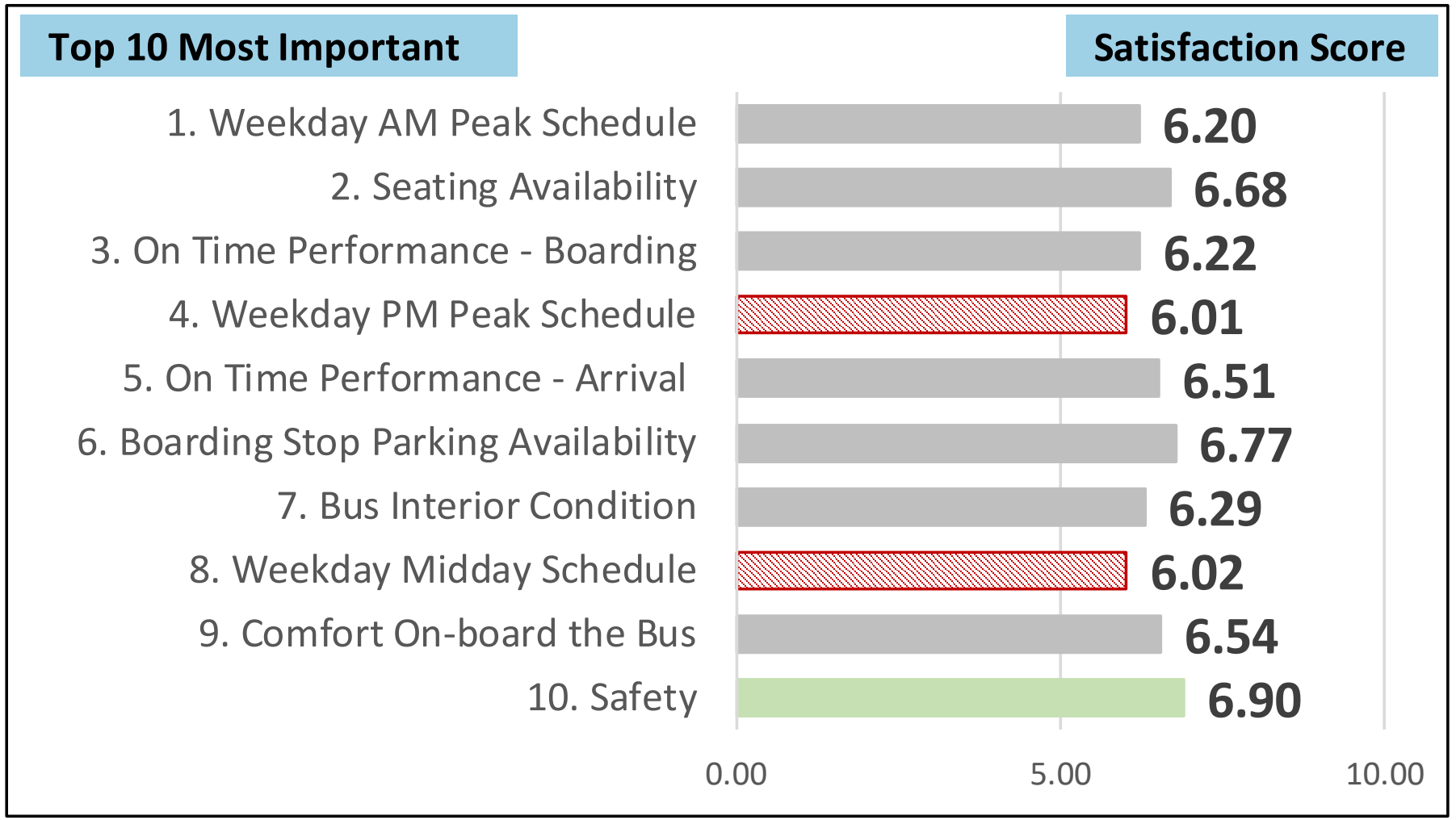
- The overall satisfaction score for Contract Carriers saw a large increase while the scores for the other modes remained fairly consistent since the spring of 2022

TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS Customers

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

BUS SYSTEM



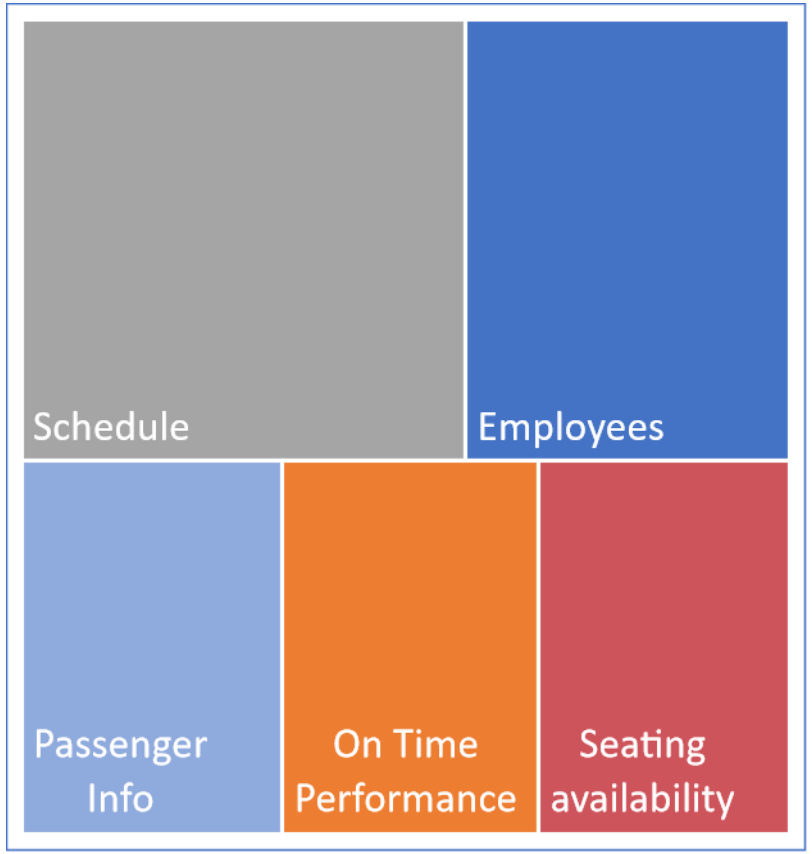
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of BUS Comments

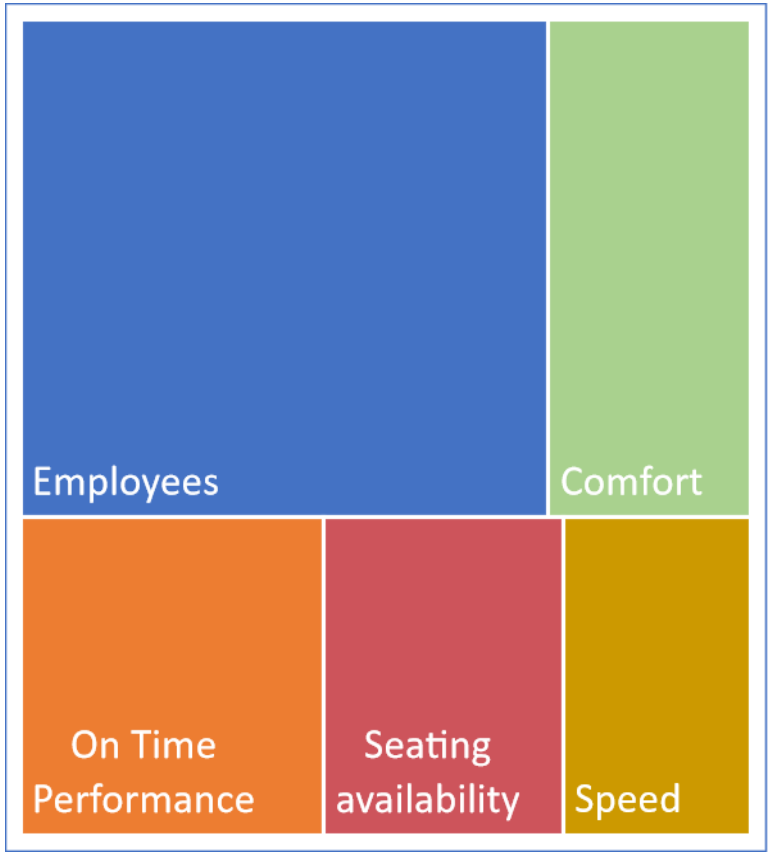
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



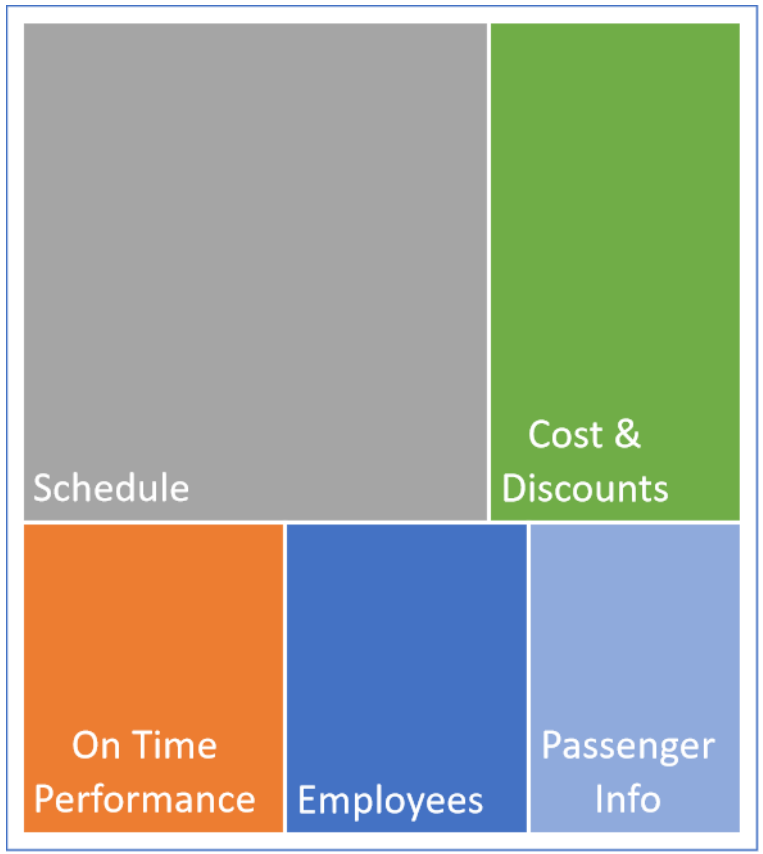
7,503 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



5,747 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



5,386 "Encourage" Comments

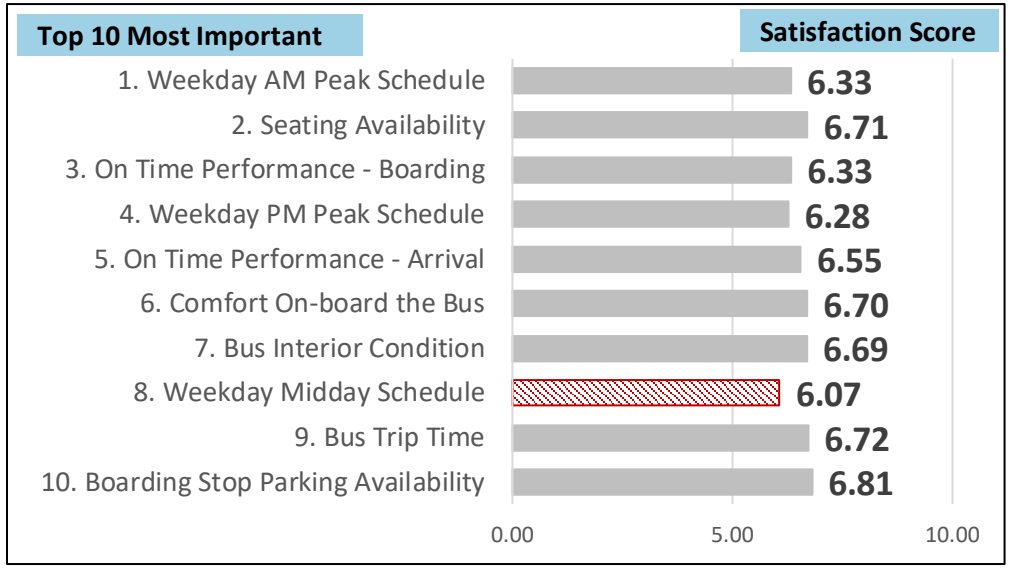
12,613 Bus Surveys

TRANSIT

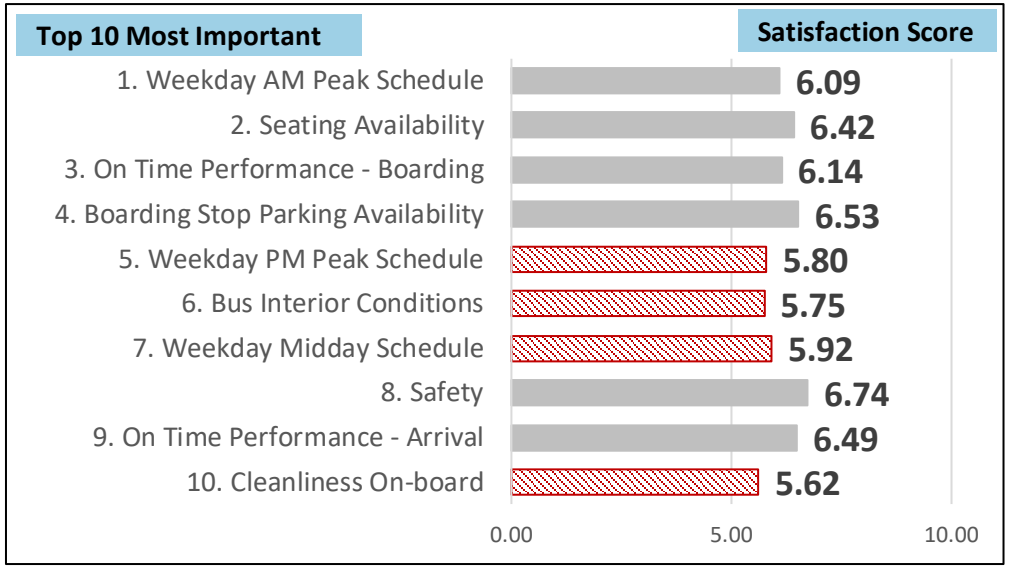
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS Customers by Bus Market and Score

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

NY INTERSTATE

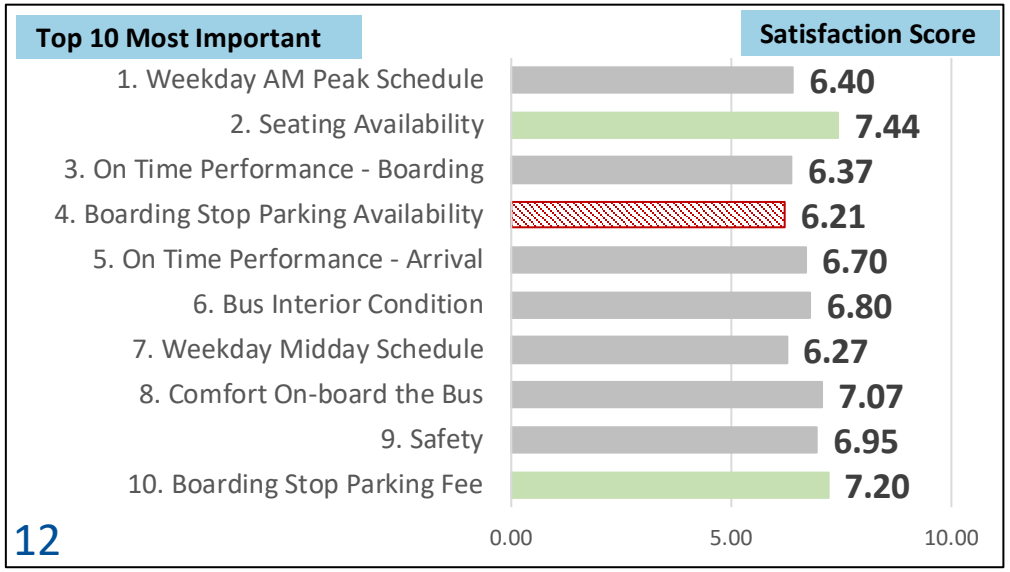


NORTH JERSEY LOCAL

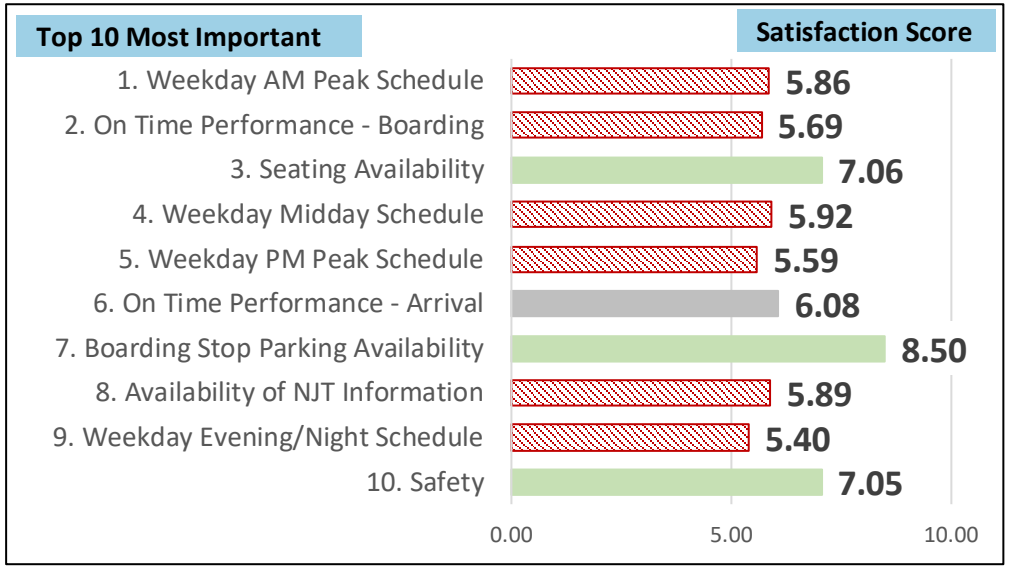


	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

SOUTH JERSEY



CONTRACT CARRIERS



TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Bus Schedule Changes to Improve On-Time Performance

- Ongoing schedule adjustments to running times and operator recovery to improve overall systemwide OTP
- Between April and September 2022:
  - Running time adjustments to 74 bus routes to improve reliability and connectivity
  - New evenly-spaced headways to close service gaps on all Big Tree, Greenville, Hilton, Orange, Ironbound, Wayne, Westwood and Washington Twp. lines
  - Restoration of full Philadelphia bus service in June 2022
  - 27 additional revenue trips added to select lines to increase seating capacity in September 2022

Assumption of Hudson County Routes

- In June 2022, NJ TRANSIT assumed direct control of the Nos. 10, 22, 23, and 119 bus routes previously operated by contract carriers. Improvements included:
  - Adjustments to running times to improve reliability and overall connectivity
  - Additional articulated vehicles added to the No. 119 service daily
  - Operation of No. 10 service out of two garages for better flexibility
  - A gate change at PABT on the No. 119 to allow more frequent service PM peak service

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Port Authority Bus Terminal Gate Changes

- In June 2022, gate changes were implemented at PABT to improve the customer experience
- 18 routes were reassigned to different gates
- Improved flow of bus traffic around and through the terminal
- Improved OTP to New York bus routes
- Increased loading and queuing space for the No. 126 line

Opening of Westwood Garage

- In September 2022, NJ TRANSIT opened the Westwood Garage, previously occupied by Rockland Coaches
- Six routes that previously operated from Oradell were moved to Westwood: Nos. 155, 157, 165, 167, 168 and 177
- The acquisition of Westwood has allowed for the replacement of aging 40-foot cruiser buses with brand new 45-footers, which the existing Oradell Garage does not have the space for a complete conversion

TRANSIT

Bus Score Context

Opening of Westwood Garage (continued)

- Also in September 2022, Bus Service Planning met with Westwood officials to discuss No. 165 route needs. Improvements included:
  - Re-routing service through downtown Westwood to coordinate new improved traffic flow while addressing safety concerns
  - Extending the No. 165 to serve Hackensack University Medical Center in Westwood with two new bus stops
  - Alternating deadhead routings of other bus routes to minimize vehicles operating through residential streets
  - An increase in overall seating capacity on Bergen County routes with additional 45-foot cruiser buses added to their lines thanks to the opening of the Westwood Garage

New Articulated Buses

- The strategic deployment of new articulated buses continues to increase capacity on routes that experience high ridership demand
- Since the last survey period, the No. 99 route was added to the list of bus routes using artics for capacity (Nos. 1, 25, 70, 119, 123, 125, and 126)
- Articulated buses were also added to more trips on weekday No. 119 line service, as well as to most of the line's weekend trips as of September 2022

Bus Score Context

Ongoing Delivery of New Cruiser Buses

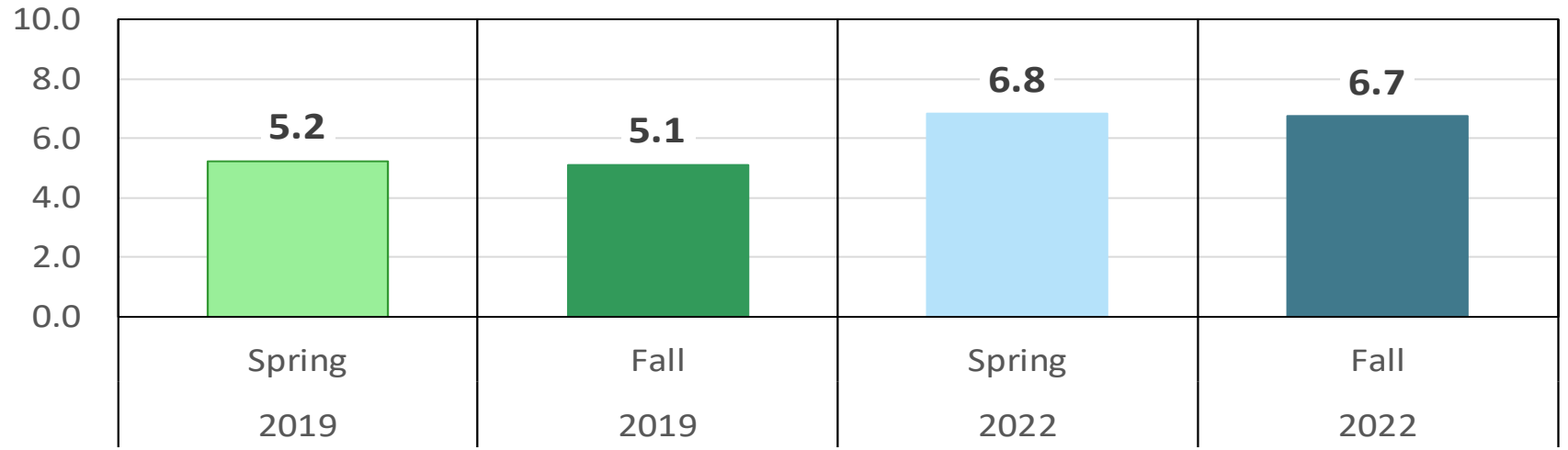
- We continue to take delivery of new 45-foot cruiser buses, with an additional 59 buses being placed into service between June and November 2022
- In addition to the updated technology of the new fleet, seating capacity is also increased per bus from 49 to 57 seated customers

Battery Electric Buses

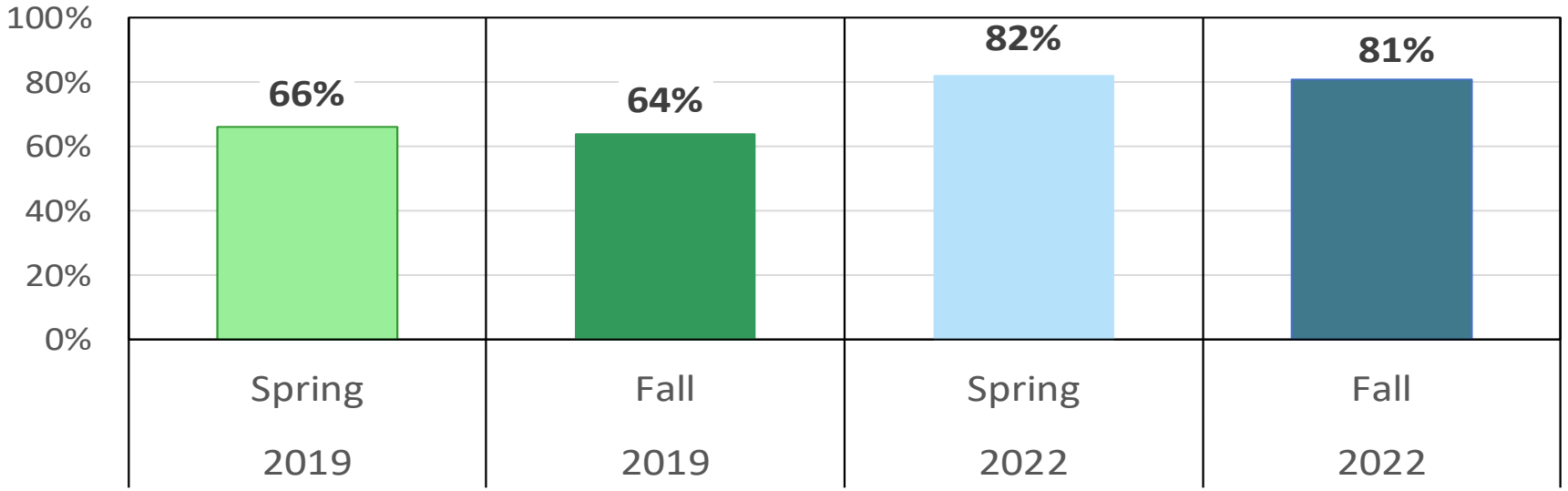
- In October 2022, the first of our new battery-electric buses went into revenue service on the No. 452 route out of Newton Avenue Garage in Camden
- We are continuing the process of gathering and evaluating data from its runs to prepare for the seven additional electric buses that will be introduced to the Camden area in coming months

RAIL

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT

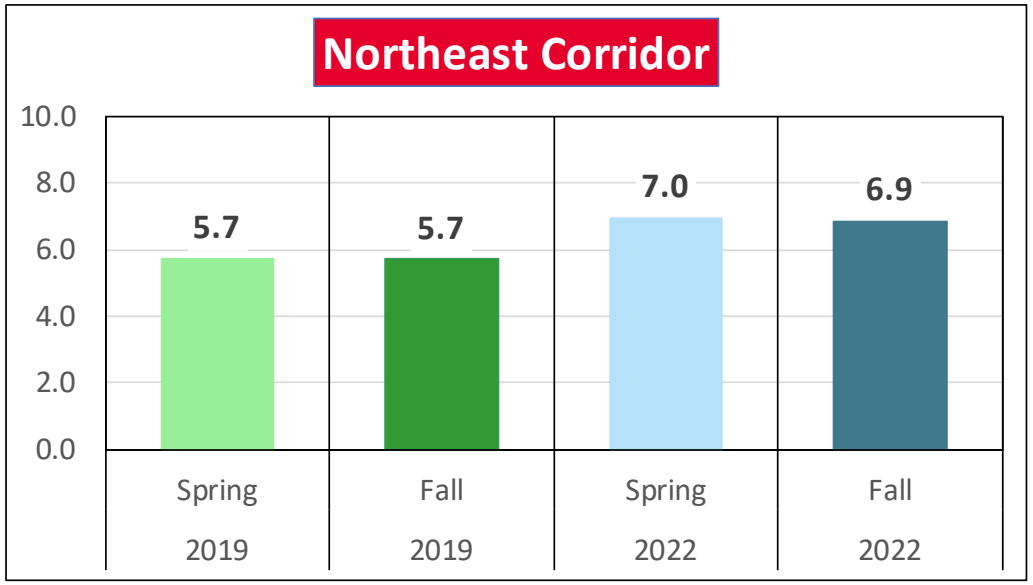


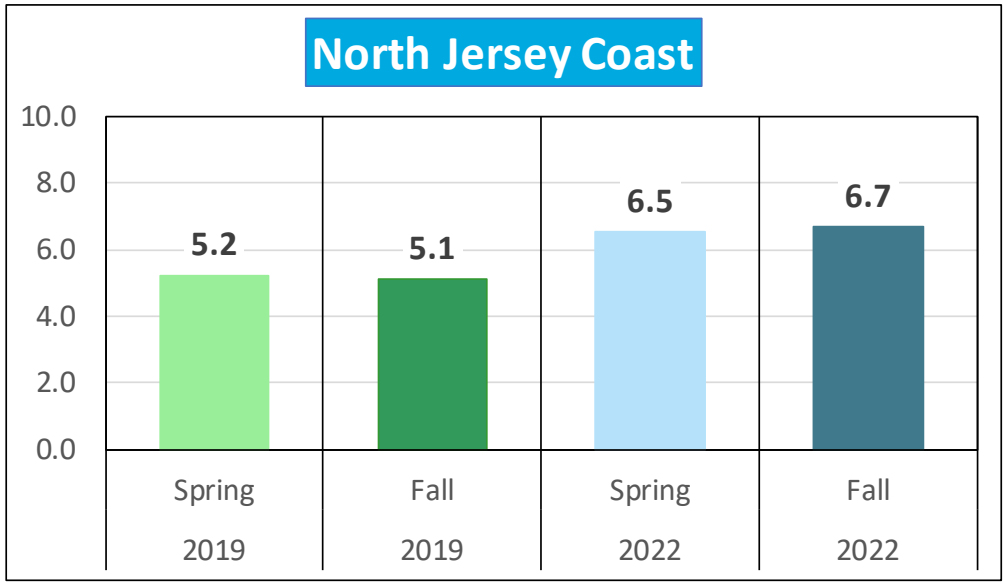
TRANSIT

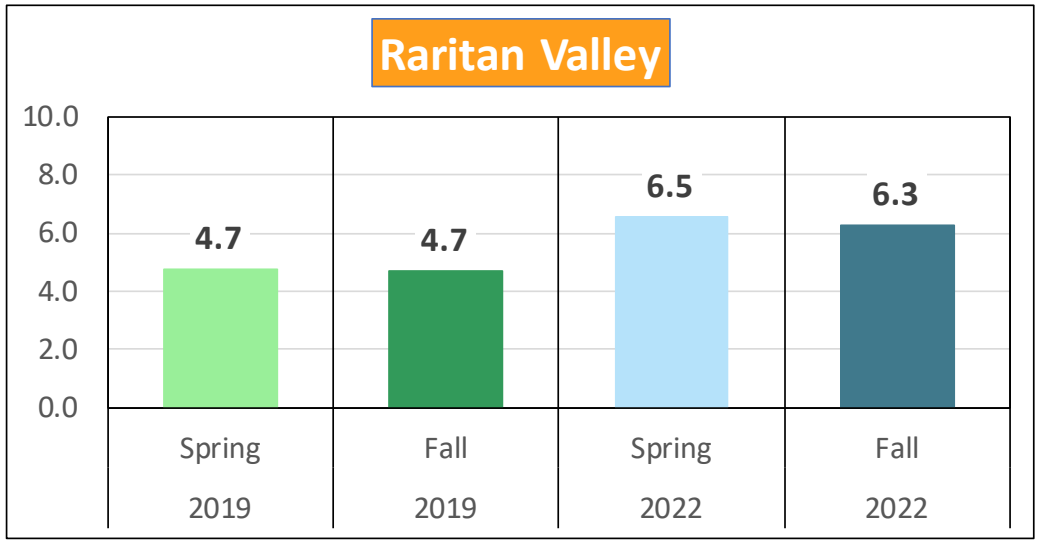
Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT by Rail Market

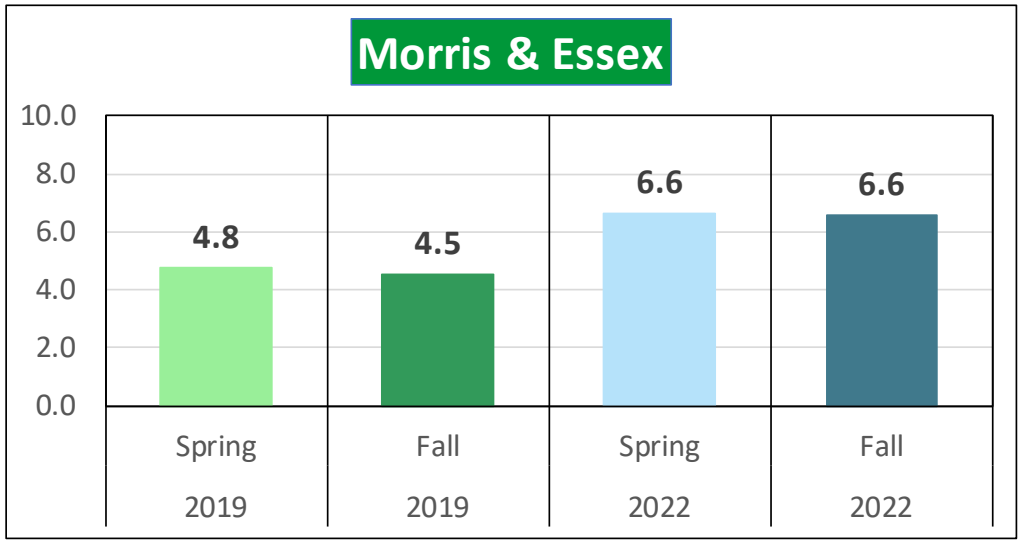
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2022







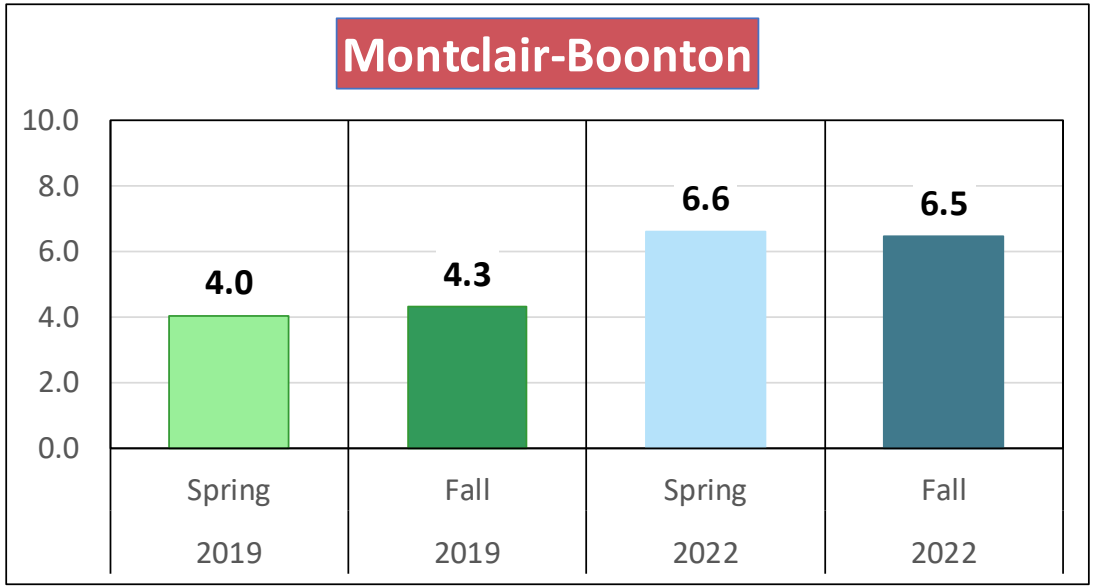


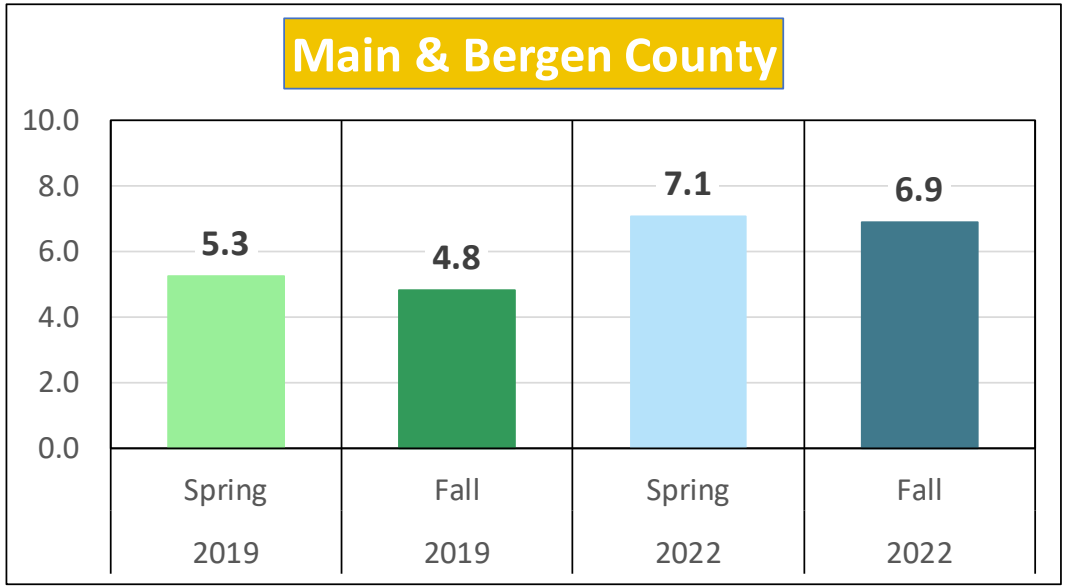
TRANSIT

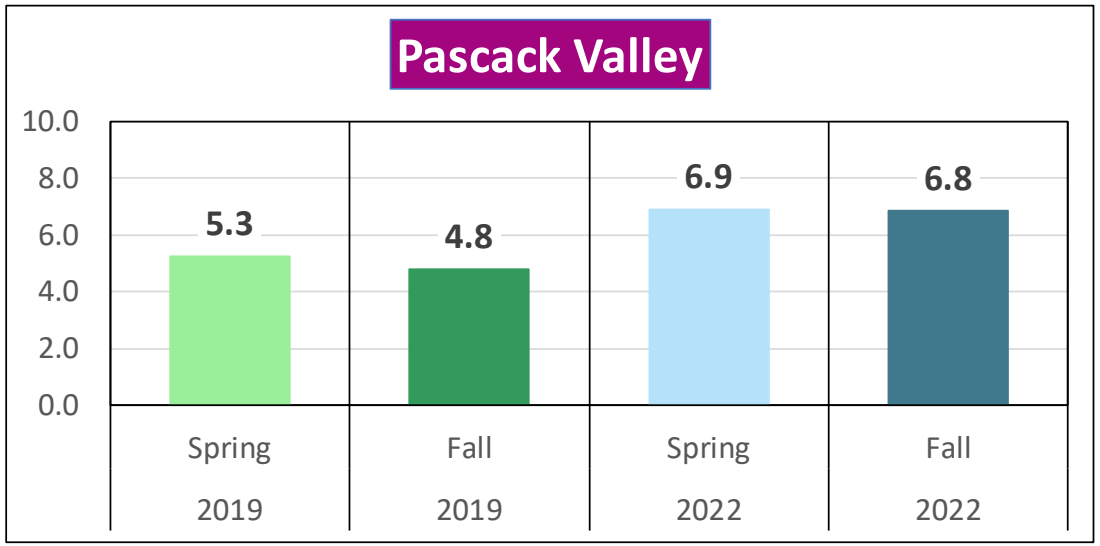
Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT by Rail Market

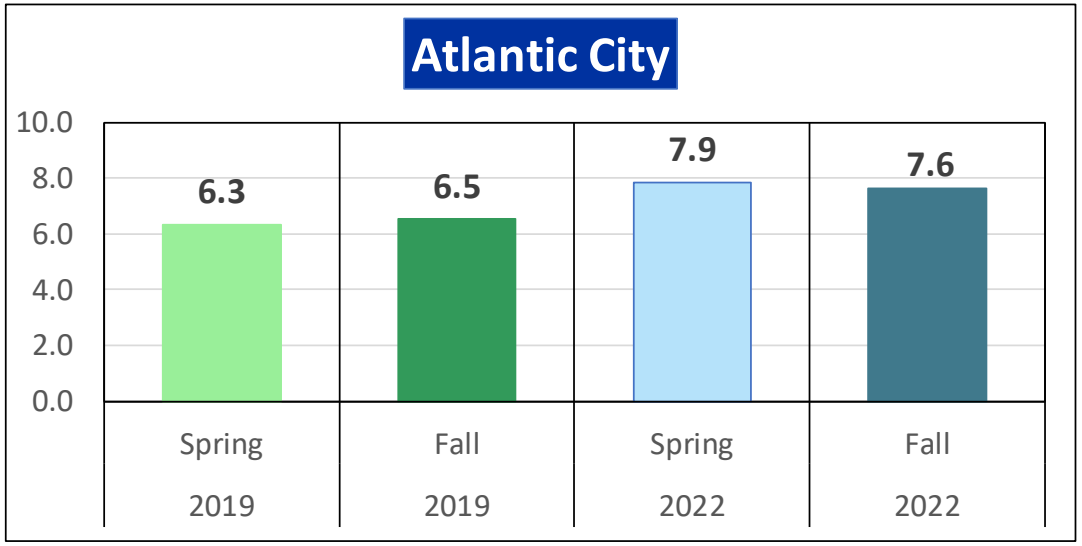
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2022





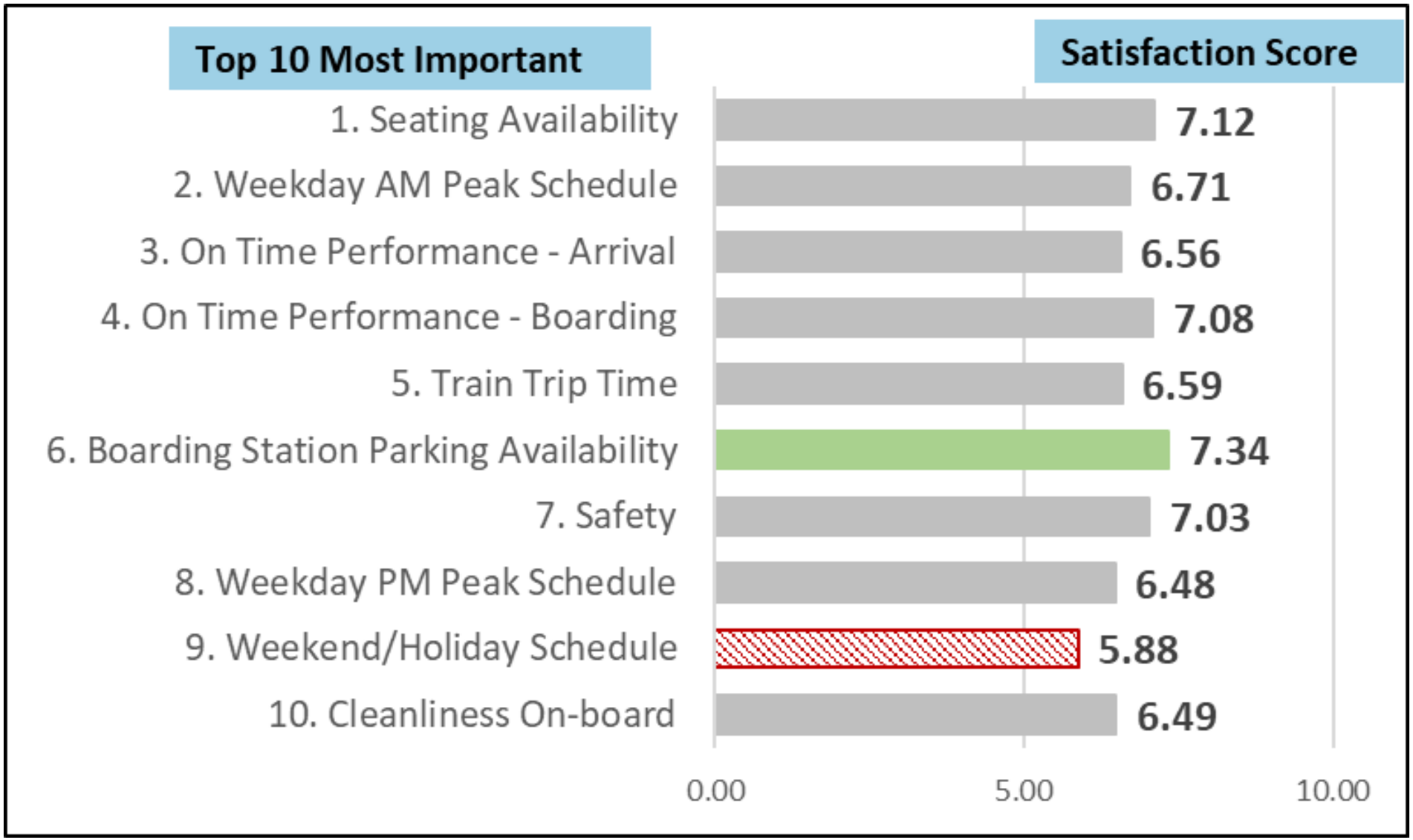




TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL CUSTOMERS

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022



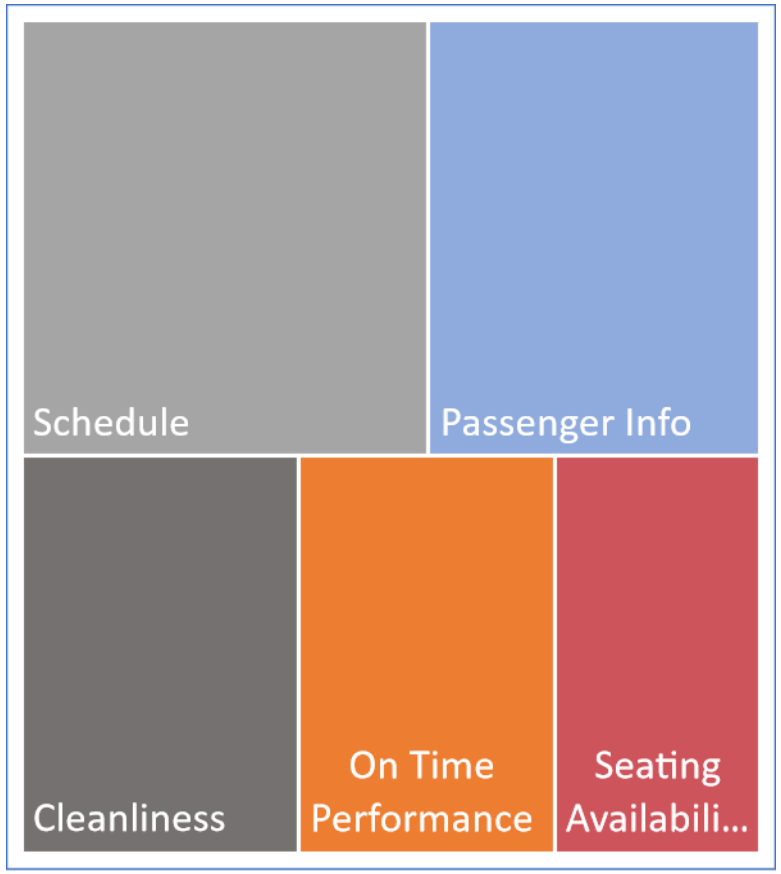
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of RAIL Comments

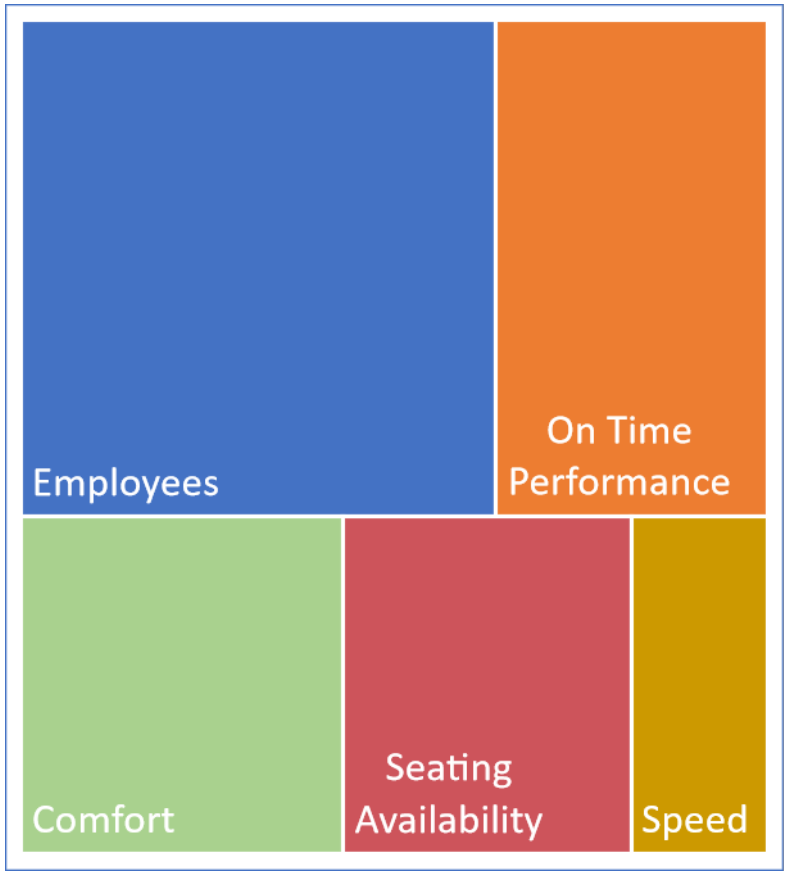
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



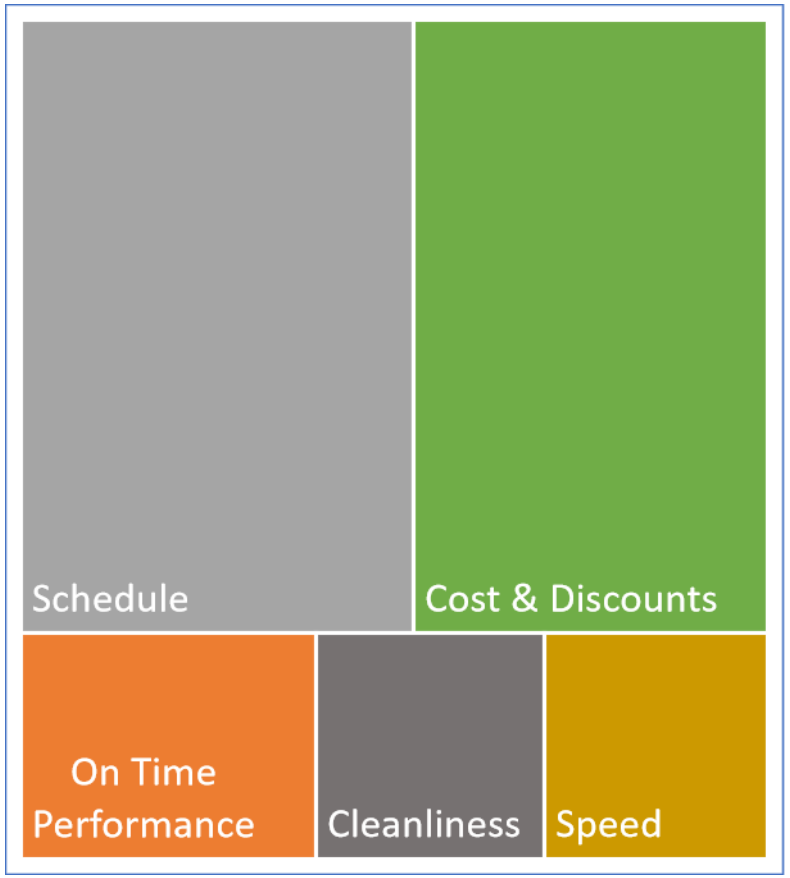
6,759 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



6,360 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



6,062 "Encourage" Comments

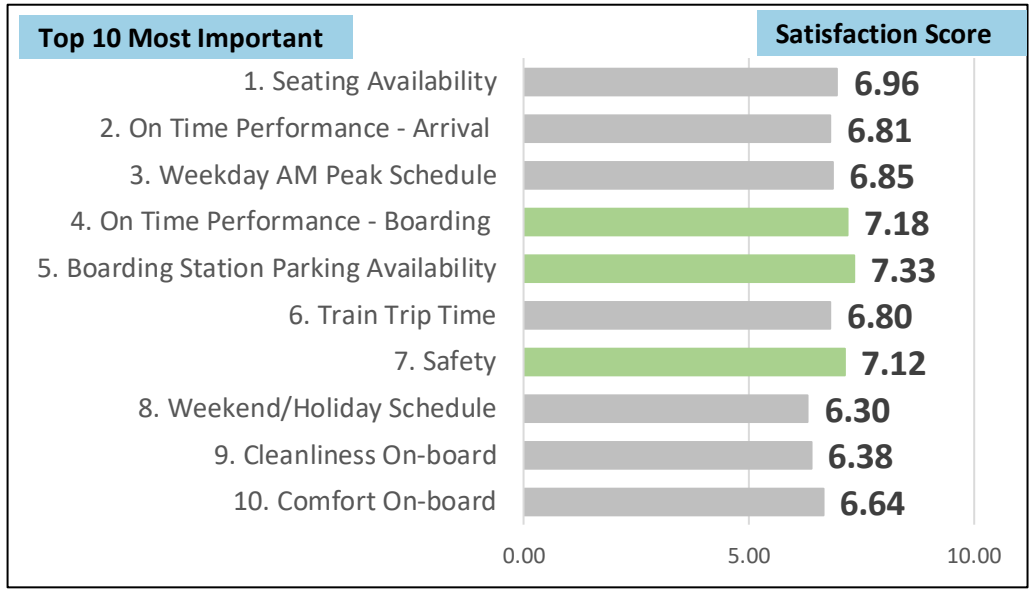
10,077 Rail Surveys

TRANSIT

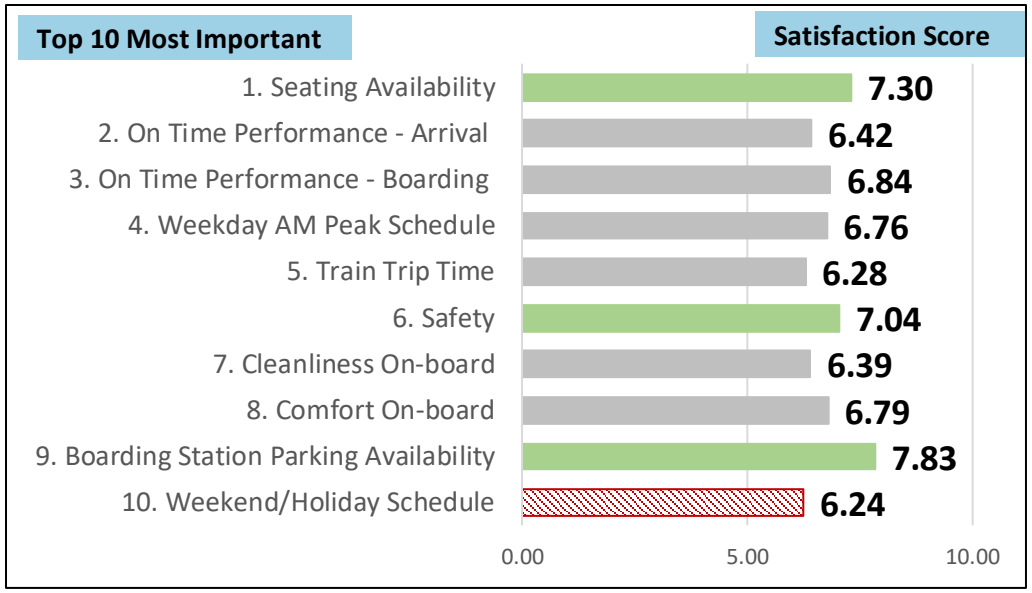
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

Northeast Corridor

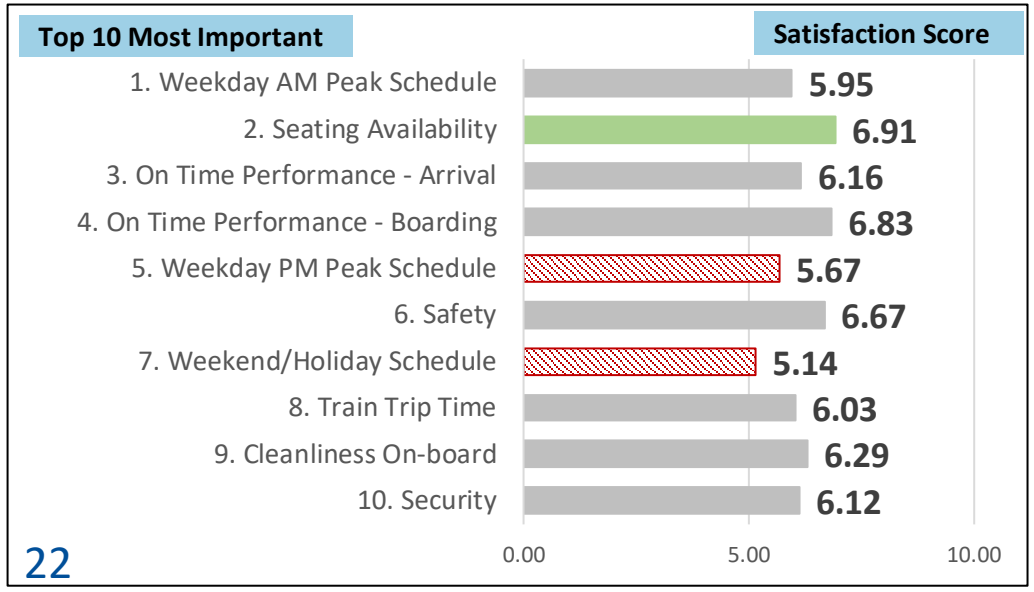


North Jersey Coast

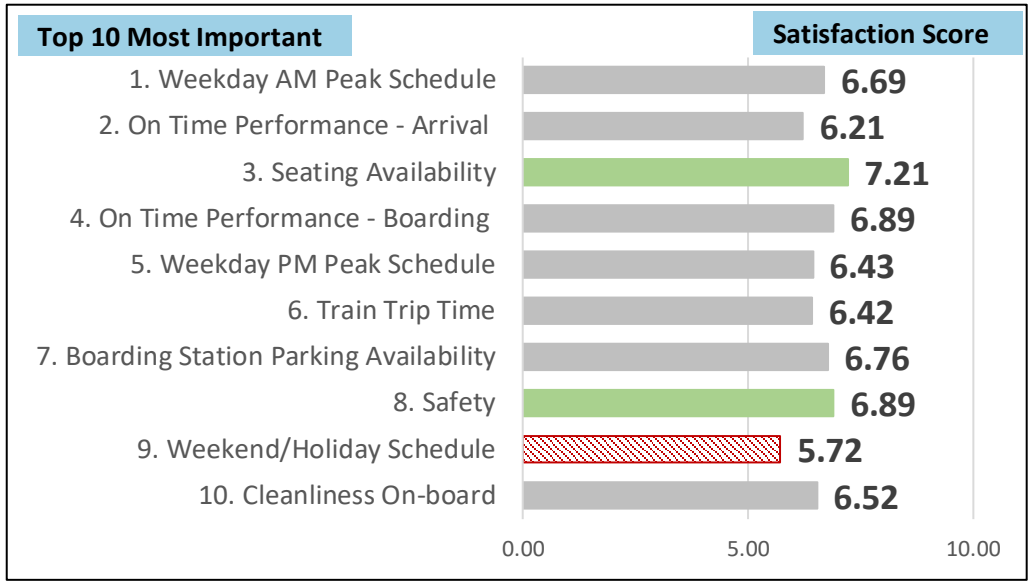


	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

Raritan Valley



Morris & Essex



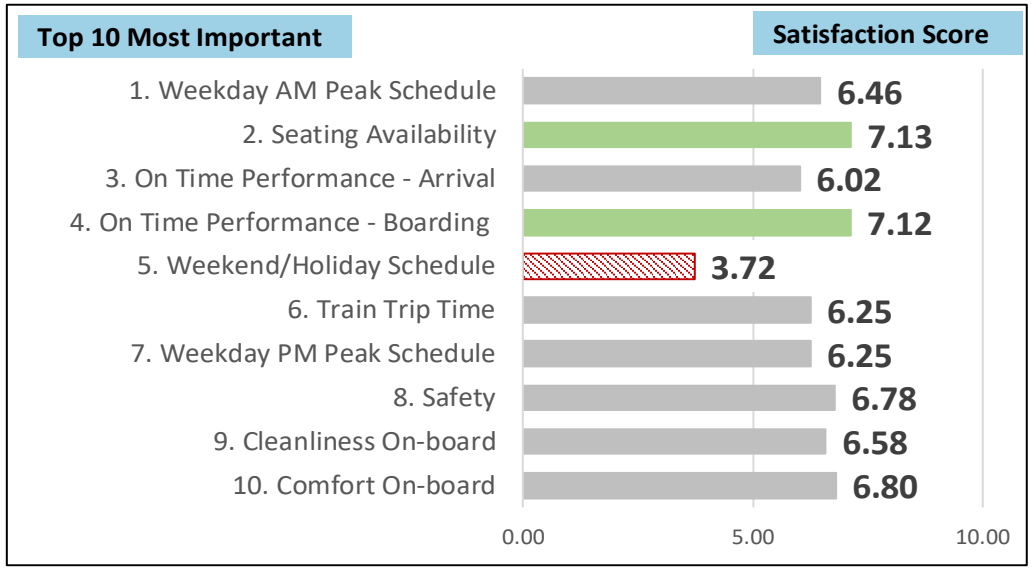
TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

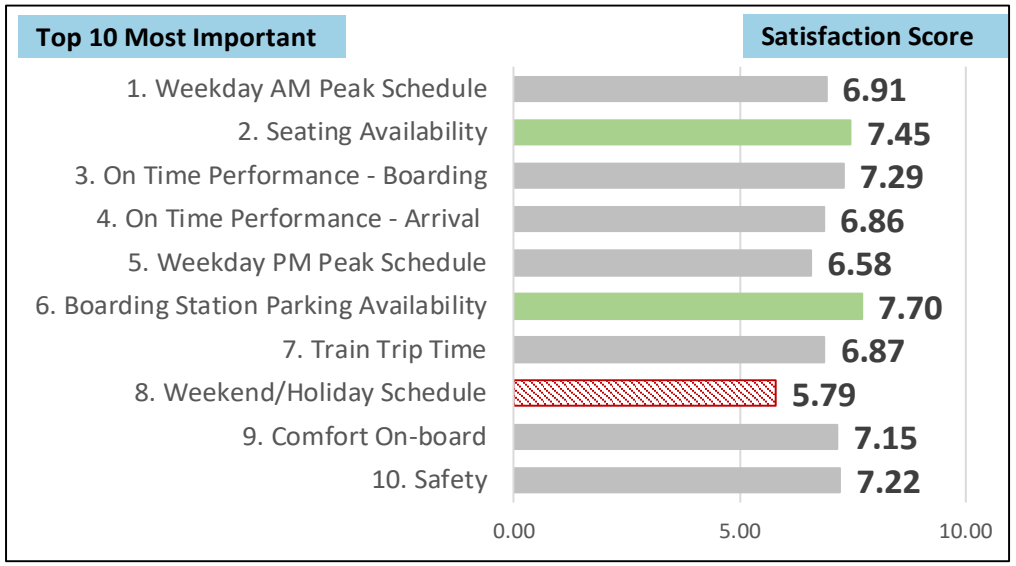
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2022

Montclair-Boonton

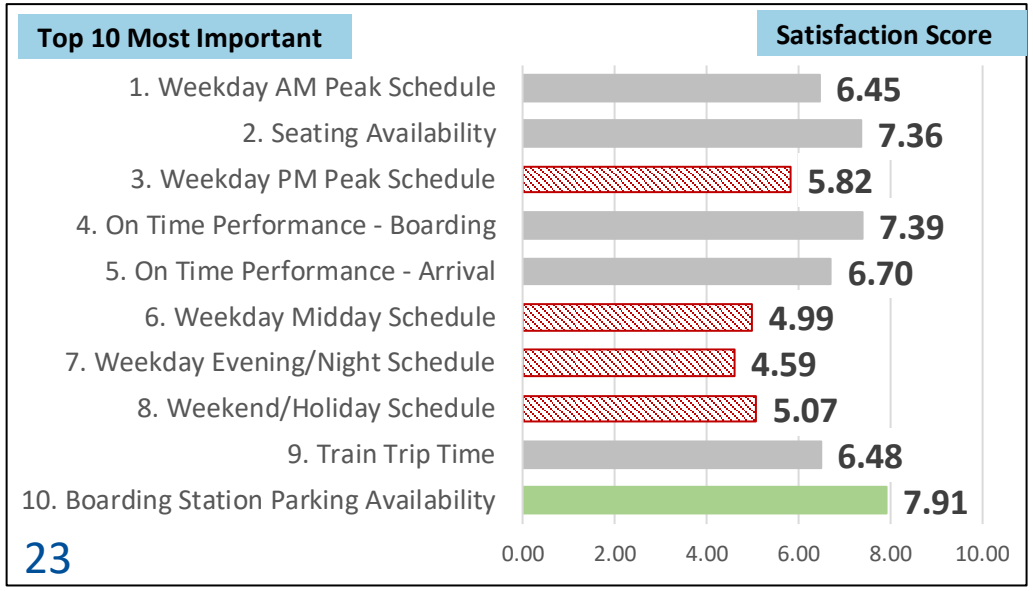


Main-Bergen/Port Jervis

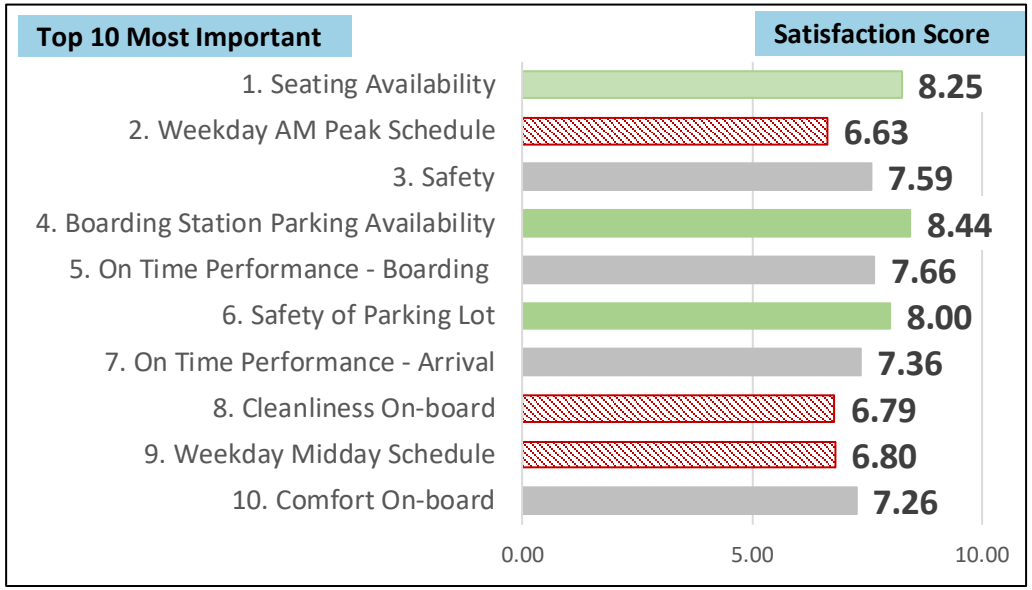


	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

Pascack Valley



ATLANTIC CITY RAIL LINE



TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

Every department in Rail Operations constantly strives to make improvements in order to enhance the customer experience. Some of the improvements we have made last year are listed below.

TRAINING:

- *ADA Training - Conductors & Locomotive Engineers*
  - Provides accessibility and improves experience for passengers with disabilities
    - Improved communication
    - Increased knowledge of service animals
    - Providing elevator access information
    - Assistance during embarkation/disembarkation
- *De-Escalation Training - Conductors & Locomotive Engineers*
  - Enhanced situational awareness
    - Increase in range of verbal/nonverbal skills to slow down sequence of events
    - Knowledge to conduct better assessments of situations
    - Improved decision-making to reduce likelihood of confrontation

TRANSIT

Rail Score Context

INFRASTRUCTURE:

- *Newark Penn Station Improvements*
  - Significant improvements to customer amenities at Newark Penn Station
    - Full-depth renovation of historic benches, including SHPO-approved laminate to facilitate cleaning and protect original timber frame
    - Lighting upgrades to LED throughout station interior
    - Full-depth renovation of historical ‘globe’ lights in main waiting room
    - Relocation of ‘Dunkin Donuts’ vendor to proper space to return main waiting room benches to original locations
    - Extra cleaning of entire main waiting room area and terrazzo floors throughout station
    - Repainting of all ceiling areas
- *Platform Repair & Stabilization* – Concrete and steel repairs, lighting upgrades, windscreen repairs, platform re-coating and sidewalk repairs at:

  - Red Bank
  - Paterson
  - Hazlet
  - Middletown
  - Woodbridge

Rail Score Context

INFRASTRUCTURE (continued):

- *LED Lighting Upgrades* – Re-lighting projects including all new LED lamps and drivers completed at the following stations:
  - Suffern
  - Towaco
  - Montclair State University Station
  - Denville
  - Clifton
  - Westmont
  - Ridgewood
  - Plauderville
- *Elevator and Escalator Modernization* – Review, scoping and execution of modernization of electronics and control panels, safety switches and mechanical components for elevators at:
  - Absecon Elevator
  - Hamilton Elevators (eastbound, westbound)
  - Paterson Elevator
  - South Amboy (all 3 elevators)
  - Newark Broad Street Elevators (track 3&1, and track 2)
  - Newark Penn Escalators #10, 17, and 35

Rail Score Context

INFRASTRUCTURE (continued):

- *Roof repairs and waiting room painting upgrades at the following stations:*
  - *Westfield*
  - *Waldwick*
  - *Metuchen*
  - *Red Bank*
- *Platform Amenity Replacement:*
  - 100 new outdoor NJ TRANSIT benches systemwide
  - 50 new garbage cans installed systemwide
  - 40 new Passenger Information Display units (PID) installed systemwide

MECHANICAL:

- *Production*
  - Producing more vehicles for service to fill out consists to ensure adequate seating availability.
  - Ordered new Multi-Level equipment to replace older Arrow cars.
  - Working towards reducing the number of mechanical incidents to provide a more reliable experience.
  - Improving the cleanliness of the train cars.

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

SERVICE PLANNING:

- *Major service changes proximate to the survey period included:*
  - Laurel Avenue bridge strike response on the NJCL, which affected weekend service
    - Changes initially implemented in May 2022 were carried through Summer 2022 and finalized in Fall 2022
    - Designed to reduce service impact of track outages necessary to support maintenance and capital construction at Perth Amboy and River Draw
    - Select NJCL trains run express on the NEC
    - Weekend Holiday score increased 5.9 to 6.2
  - Amtrak track reconstruction Rahway to Elizabeth on the NEC
    - Changes implemented July 2022; project lasted into December 2022
    - Adjustments to NEC/NJCL peak period weekday services
    - Scheduled service scores improved on NJCL, stayed steady on NEC except for evening/night schedule when impacts of work were most pronounced.

TRANSIT

Rail Score Context

SERVICE PLANNING (continued):

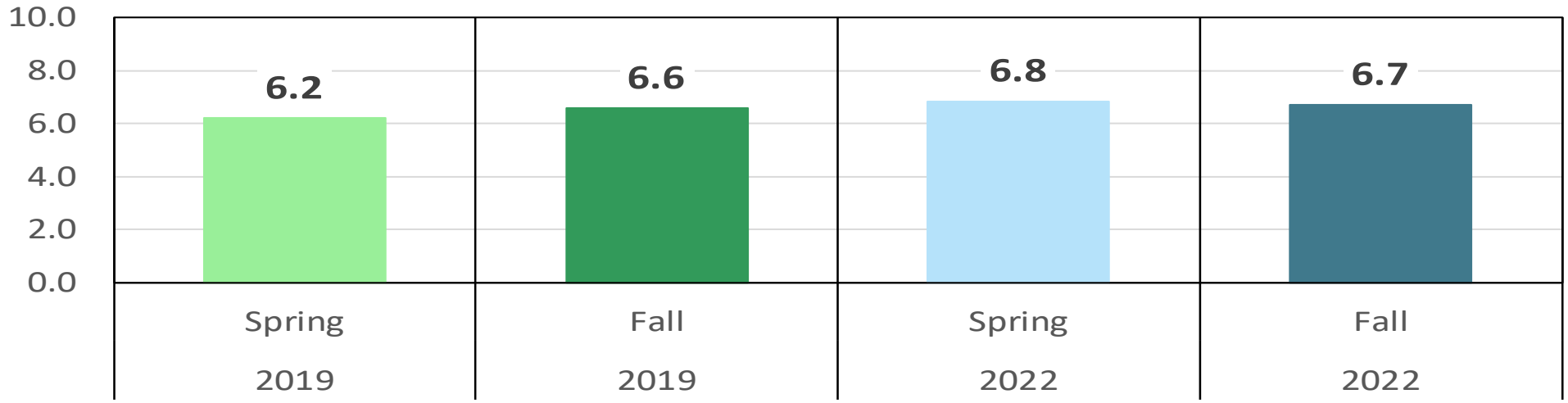
- *Overall, scheduled service scores remained steady with a maximum change of .1 for the system in scheduled service categories*
  - NJCL scheduled service increased in all categories.
  - PVL scheduled service scores decreased in all categories
    - The schedule did not change.
    - Infrastructure issues (speed restrictions)
- *The only score that declined across all lines was seating availability*
  - Increasing ridership

LIGHT RAIL

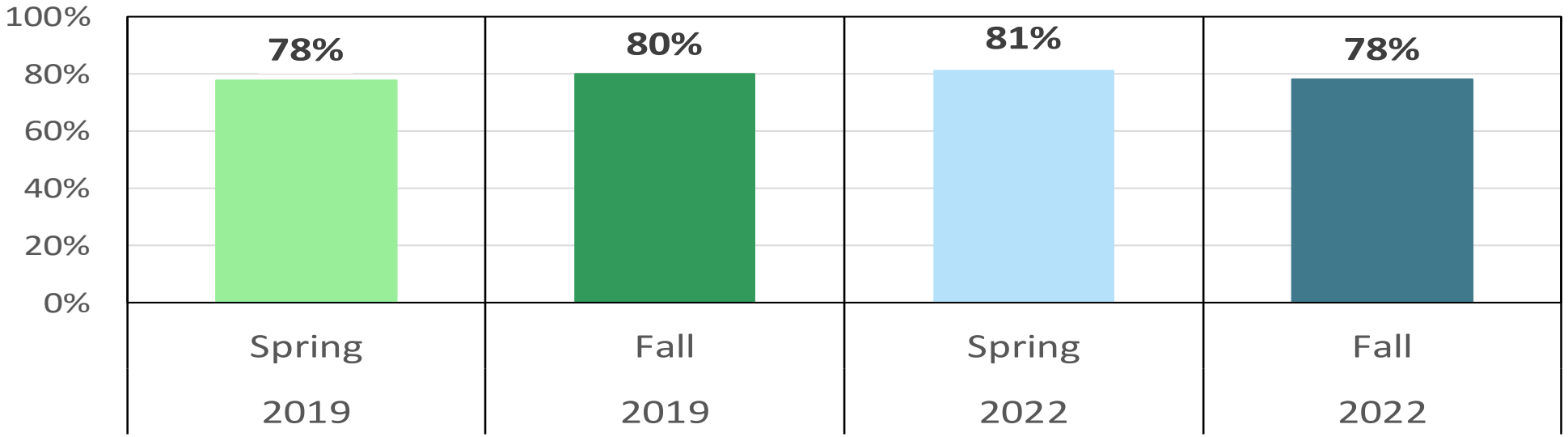
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2022

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



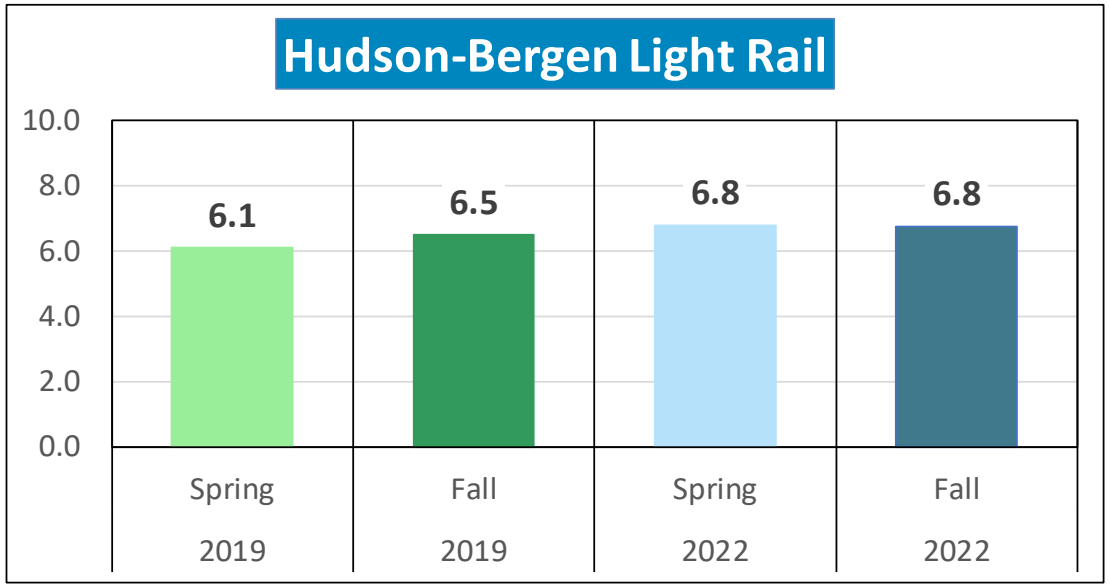
LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT

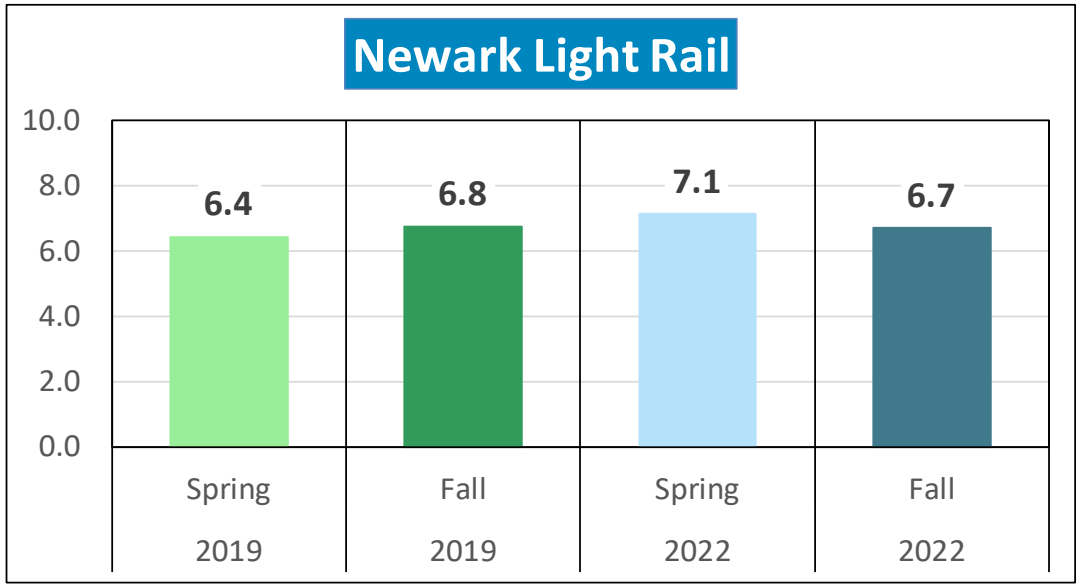


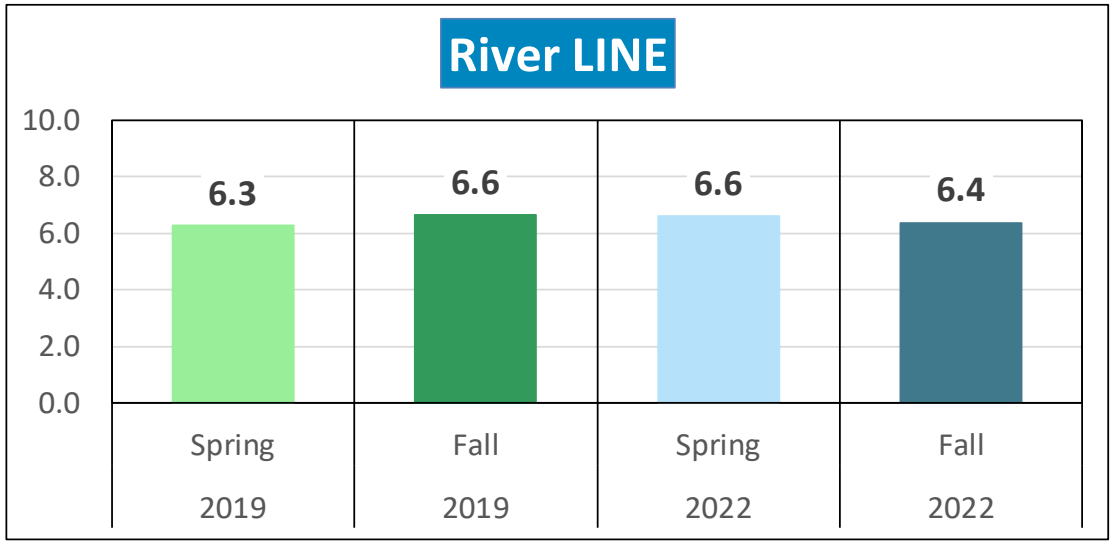
TRANSIT

Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT by Light Rail Market

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022







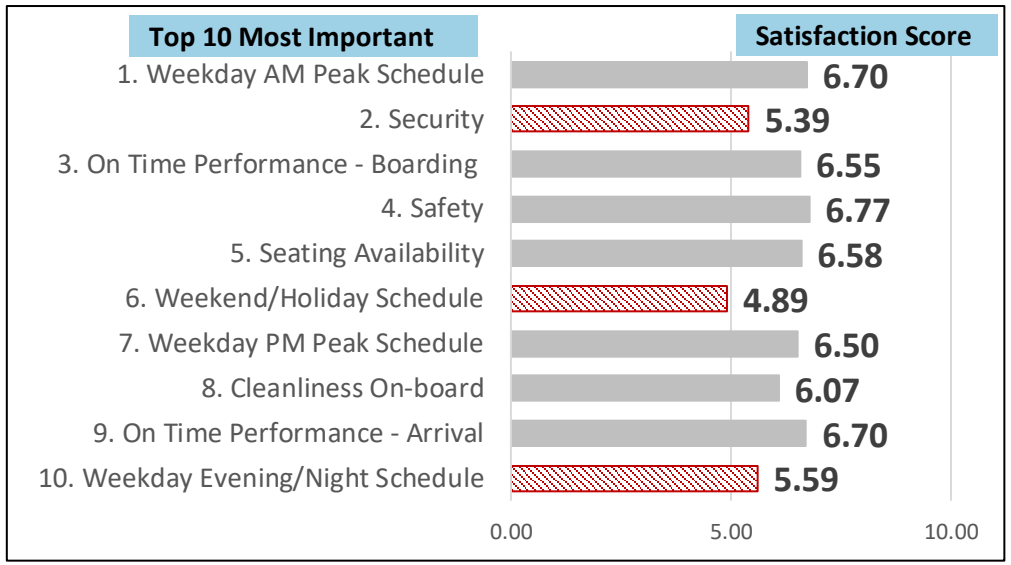
- Hudson-Bergen Overall Satisfaction remained at 6.8 for the Fall 2022 survey
- Newark Light Rail and River LINE scores dropped since the Spring 2022 survey

TRANSIT

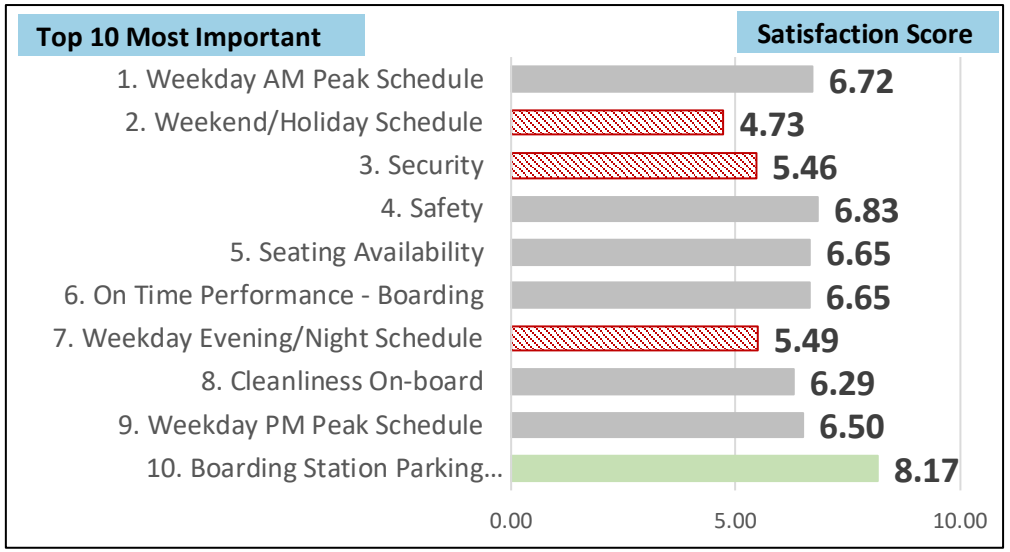
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for LIGHT RAIL Customers by Light Rail Line and Score

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

LIGHT RAIL SYSTEM

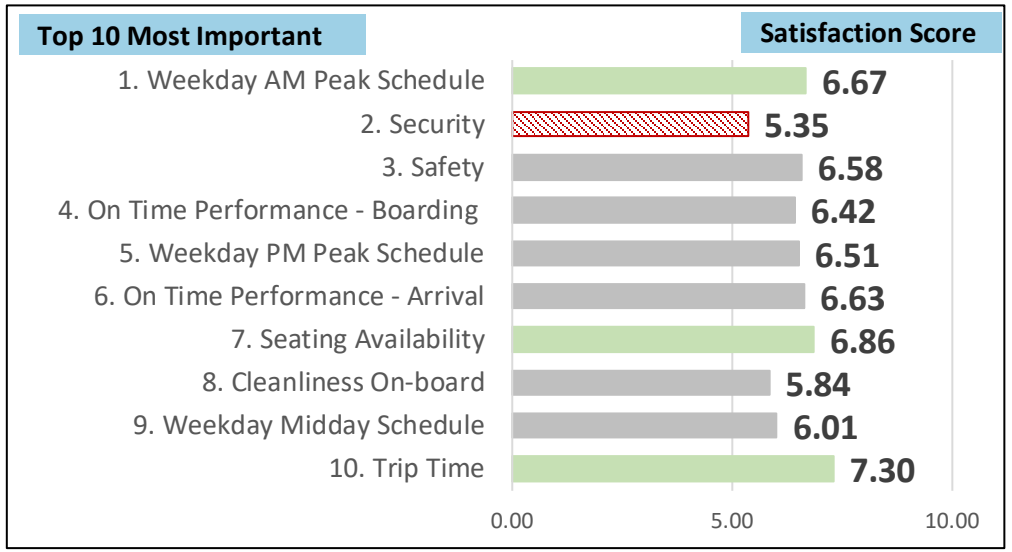


Hudson Bergen Light Rail

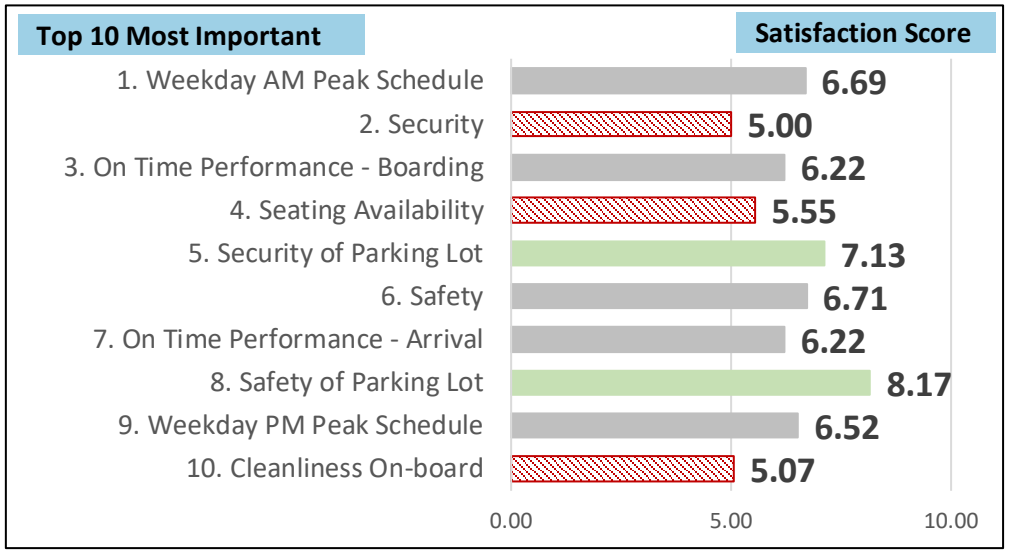


	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

Newark Light Rail



River LINE

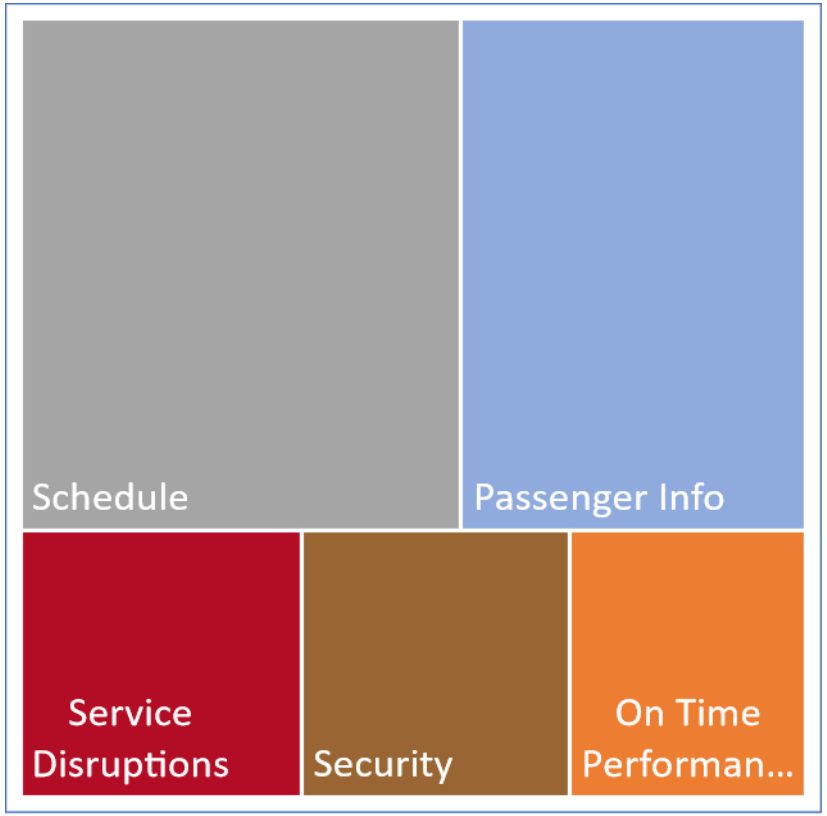


NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of LIGHT RAIL Comments

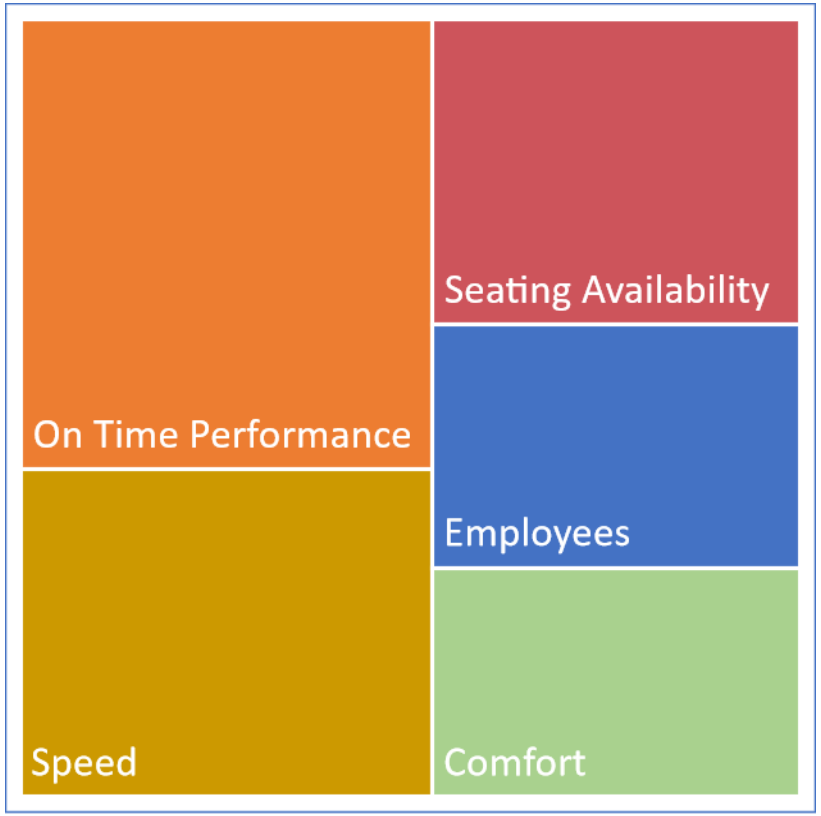
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



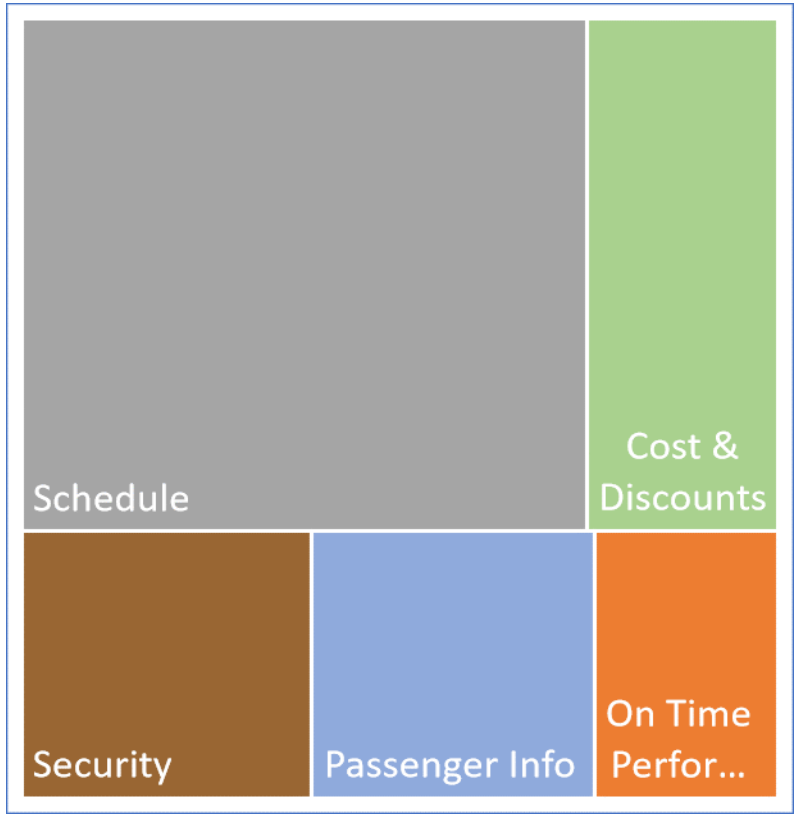
397 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



368 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



344 "Encourage" Comments

653 Light Rail Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

Security

- Increasing the presence of station attendants across all three light rail lines
- Monitoring control centers to coordinate effectively with NJTPD through drills and other exercises to ensure proper emergency response
- Working with customer service to increase customer awareness of available resources

Weekend/Holiday Schedule

- Weekend service outages and track work during Summer and Fall 2022, particularly on HBLR and NLR, resulted in a decrease in the weekend/holiday schedule score
- Mitigation efforts include:
  - Extensive coordination with Customer Service, Passenger Communications, and Social Media post service advisories in advance
  - Increased use of custom, automated announcements onboard light rail vehicles and at stations
  - Deployment of attendants and ambassadors to help assist and inform HBLR and NLR customers

TRANSIT

Light Rail Score Context

On-Time Performance

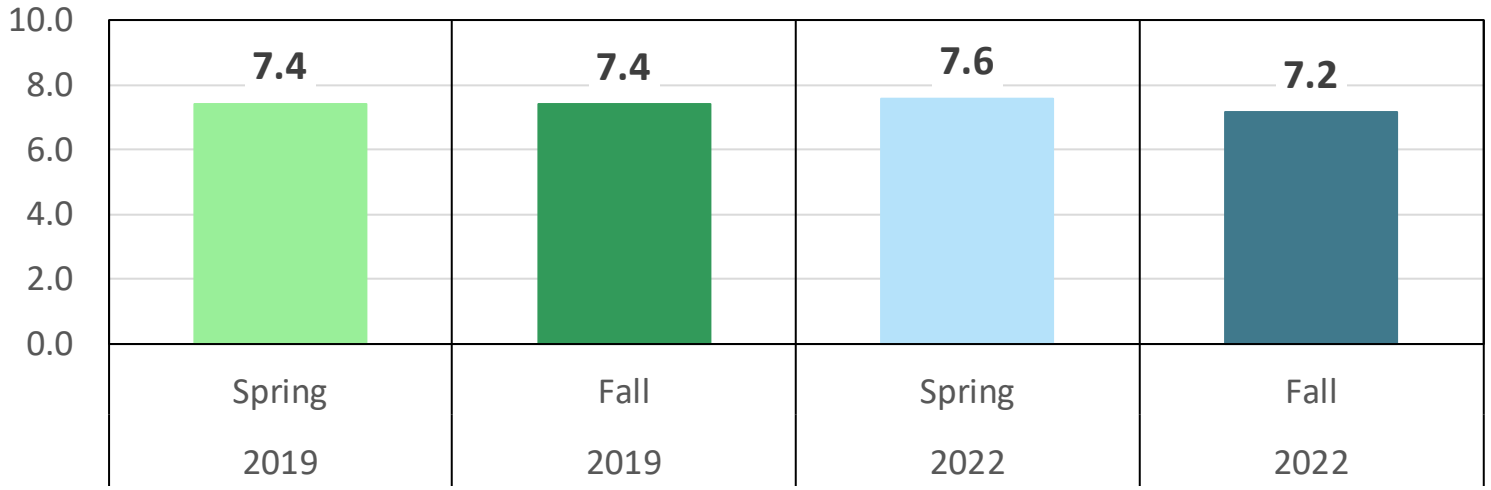
- Increased monitoring of light rail service across all three systems helps with meeting and maintaining OTP standards
- Upgrades to system infrastructure (primarily on HBLR) including track and signal/switches upgrades and maintenance help to minimize disruptions on the system and enhance OTP
- Providing alternate and/or supplemental service (e.g. bus bridges, extra trains) to customers during extended service disruptions helps to mitigate the impact to customers and maintain OTP (particularly on the River Line)

Access Link

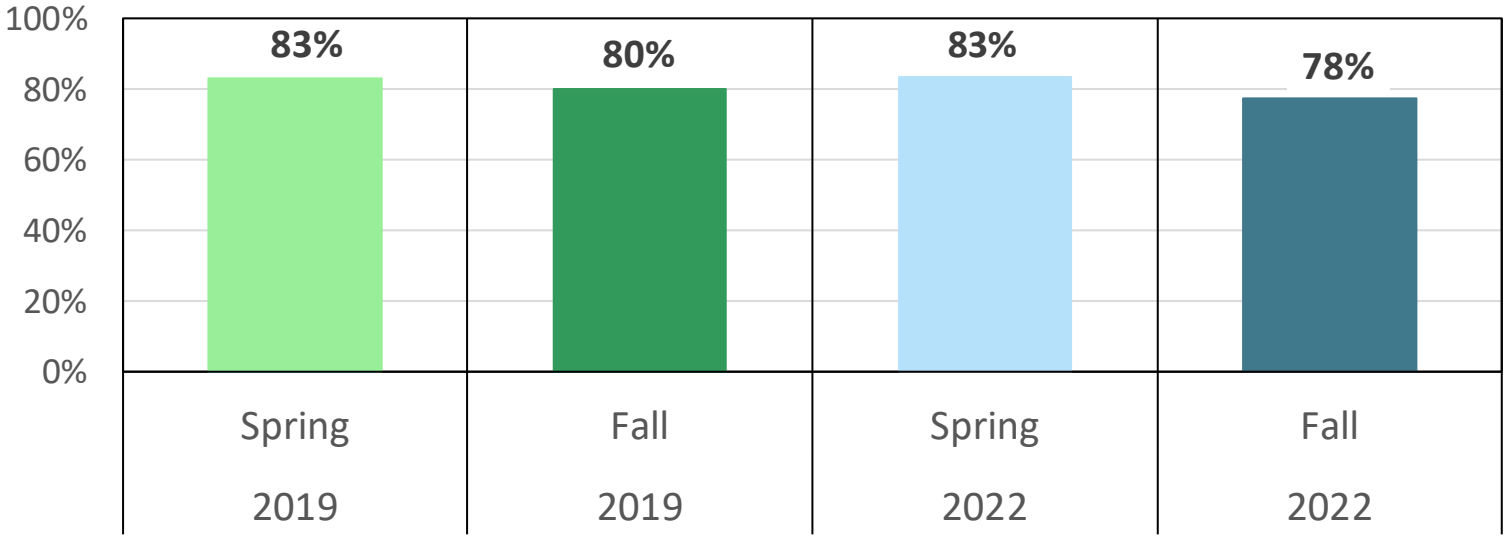
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Fall 2022

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



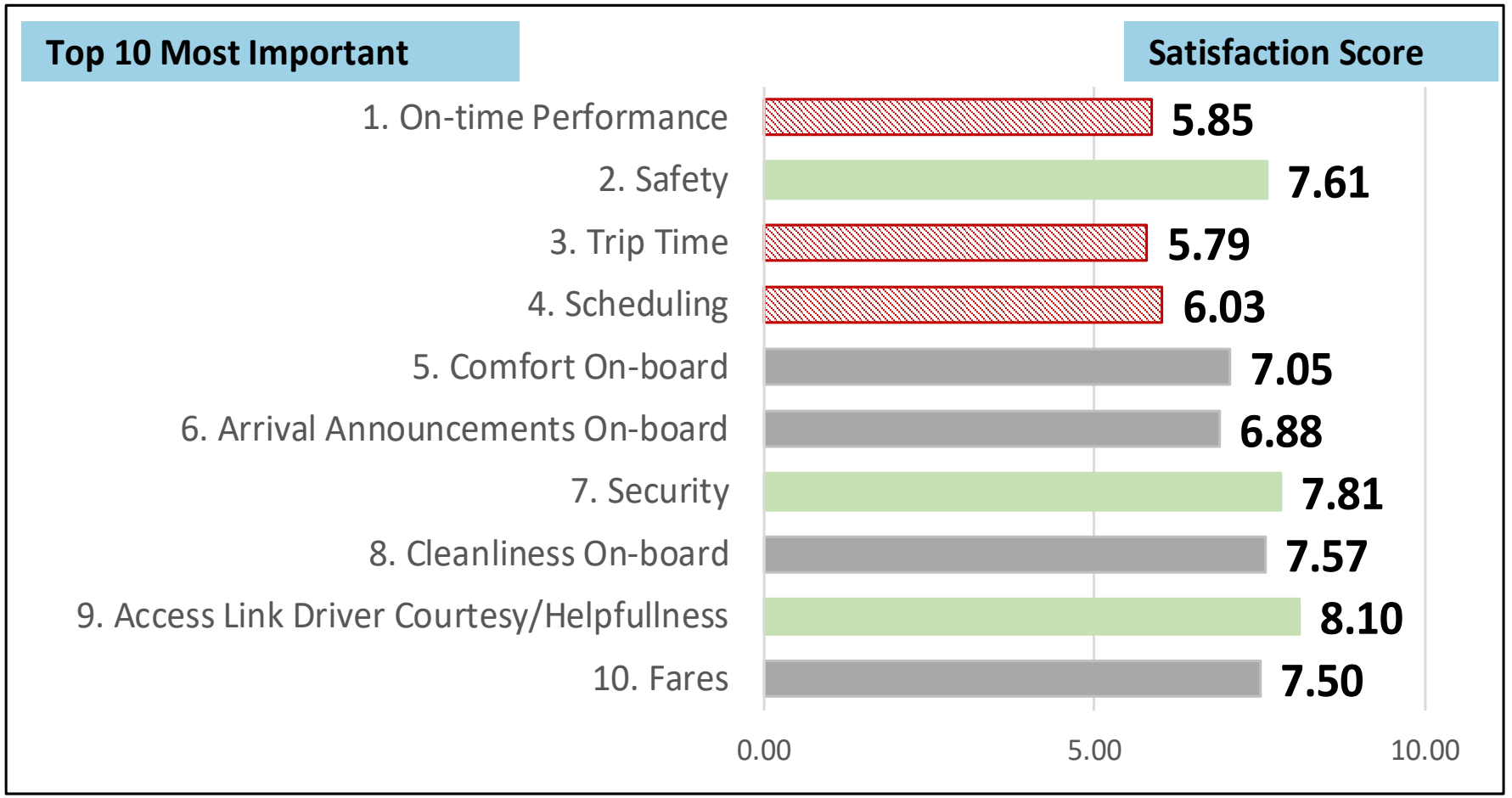
LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT



- ACCESS LINK Overall Satisfaction score is 7.2 and the Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT to a friend or family member is 78%

TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for ACCESS LINK Customers



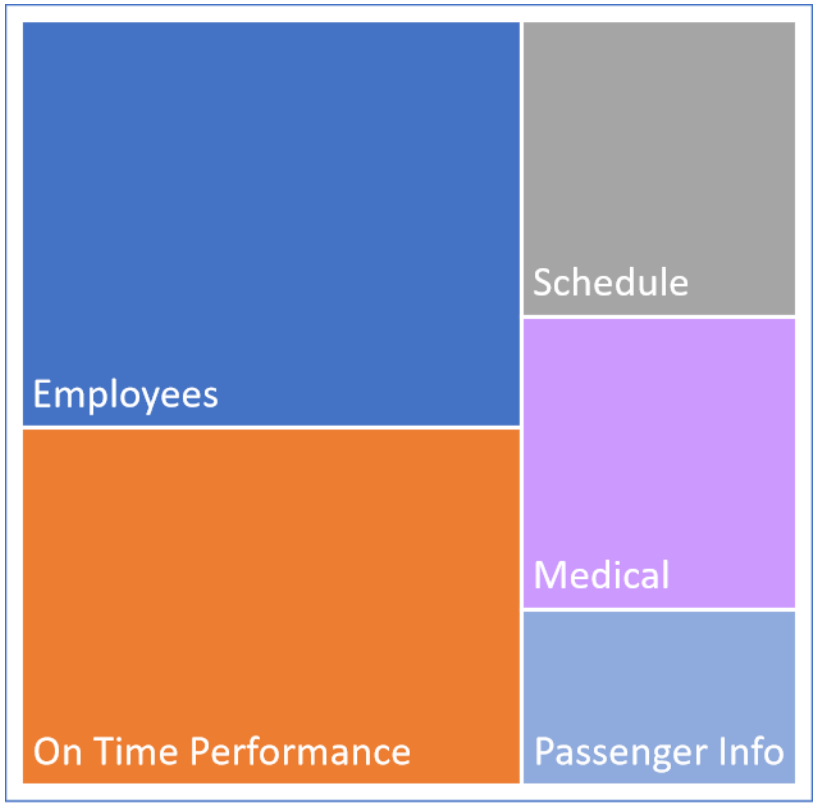
	Top 10 Satisfaction Score
	Bottom 10 Satisfaction Score
	Mid-Range Satisfaction Score

TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of Access Link Comments

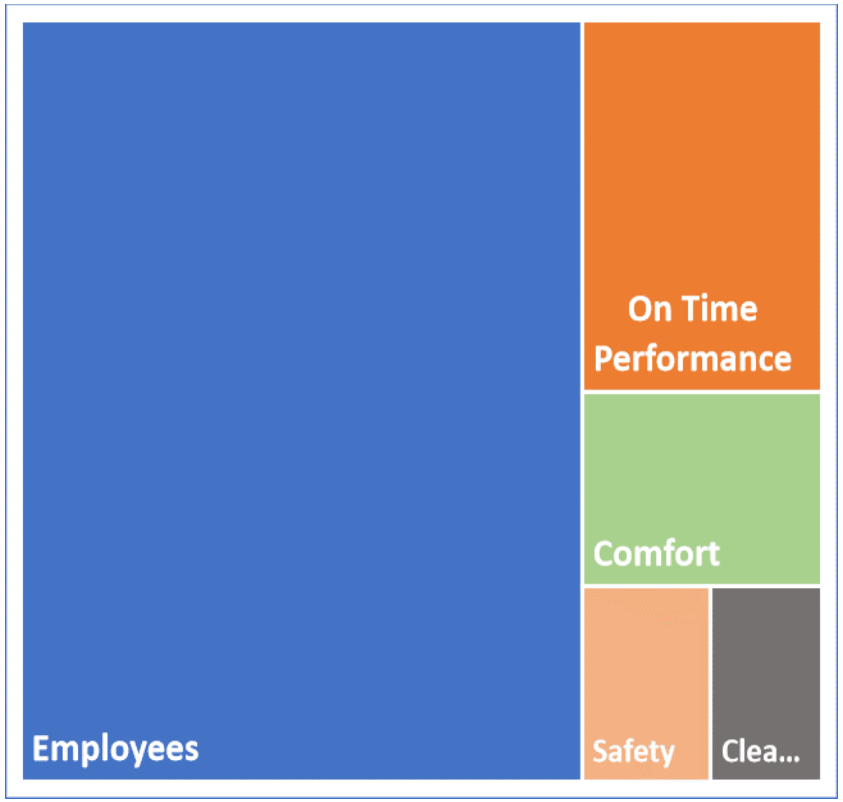
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Fall 2022

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



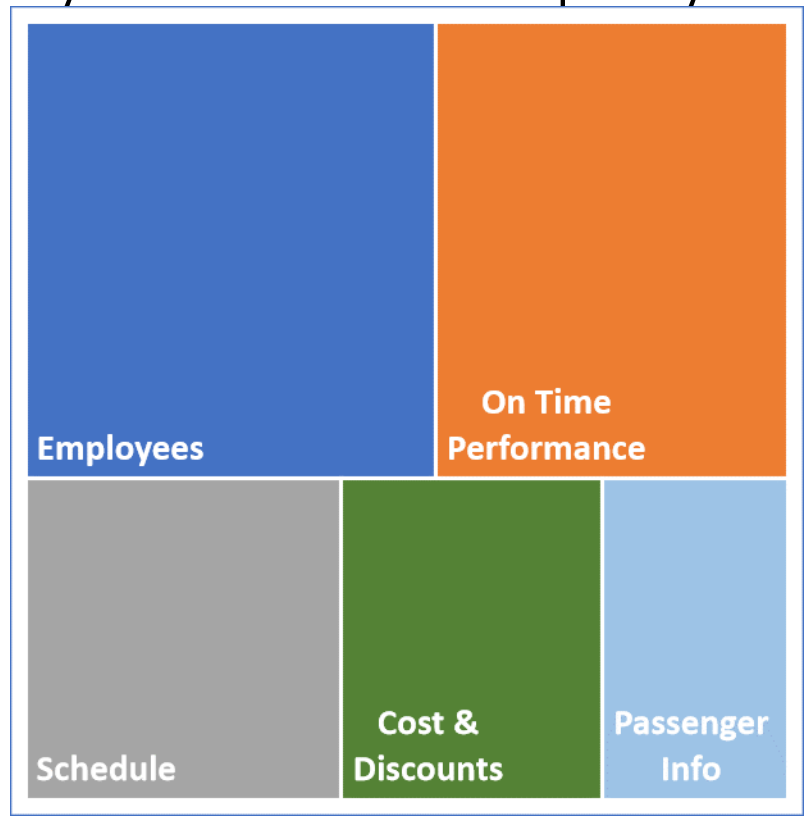
478 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



452 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



429 "Encourage" Comments

813 Access Link Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

On-Time Performance

- Increased hiring of drivers and operations support positions
- Upgraded scheduling software
- Upgraded maps
- Transition to new service provider in Region 5
- Factors affecting OTP:
  - Increased ridership
  - Increase in customer no-shows

Transportation Network Company (TNC) Partnership

- Pending partnership with Access Link service providers and UZURV, an on-demand paratransit company
- Additional supplemental services with other TNCs (e.g. VIA, Uber, Lyft) also in development to help meet growing demand

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

Fleet

- Purchase of 258 new cutaway minibuses authorized in December 2021 to modernize the fleet by replacing older model vehicles
- Access Link began taking delivery of the new vehicles in late October 2022
- 29 of the new vehicles are operating in revenue service

Communications

- Enhanced IVR pilot program
- Focus on outreach efforts
- Continuation of “Mobility Matters” series on YouTube
- Increased utilization of Twitter and MyTransit alerts
- Application of Field Surveillance Program

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Summary

- 2022 Fall Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT Score is 6.8
- 81 percent of customers would recommend NJ TRANSIT – the largest percent to recommend since the survey started
- The scores and customer comments have been shared with the operating groups
- Scores will be posted on the NJ TRANSIT website
- The next survey will be administered in the Spring of 2023

TRANSIT